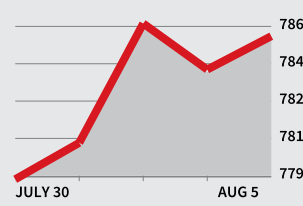


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 78581.00 (+152.05)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24624.65	+9.75
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.90	-0.02
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.11	-0.26
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	145043.00	+2749
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	224562.00	+5927

RESERVES BOOST.

Central banks bought 51 tonnes of gold in June, highest monthly purchase so far in 2026 p10



TECHNOPHILE.

Motorola Edge 70 Max targets gamers with power, endurance and vibrant 144Hz display p4

QUICKLY.

NIFTY VOLATILITY

SEBI 'unlikely to review' Closing Auction Session



Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is unlikely to immediately revisit its newly introduced Closing Auction Session (CAS) even as sections of the market raised concerns following sharp swings in the Nifty's official closing value. Instead, the regulator asked brokers to improve investor participation and visibility of auction prices, according to sources aware of the discussions. **p8**

REGULATORY MOVE

TRAI rolls out draft norms for network slicing tech

New Delhi: Telecom regulator TRAI on Wednesday rolled out draft quality of service norms to accommodate mobile network slicing technology by telecommunications companies. The draft rules also propose to allow telecom operators charge different rates for 4G, 5G and other services they offer. **p5**

MPC holds repo rate at 5.25% amid uncertainties

NEUTRAL. RBI trims FY27 retail inflation forecast to 5%; projects GDP 6.7% growth

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

The Reserve Bank of India's Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) unanimously voted to keep the policy repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent and retained its "neutral" monetary policy stance, citing uncertainties around the South-West monsoon, El Nino conditions, geopolitical developments and global trade policy.

The decision, taken during the MPC meeting, marks the fourth consecutive policy review in which the repo rate has remained unchanged. The MPC maintained its neutral stance for the seventh straight meeting.

Alongside the policy decision, the RBI revised its FY27 Consumer Price Index (CPI)-based inflation forecast downward to 5 per cent from 5.1 per cent, while raising its real GDP growth projection marginally to 6.7 per cent from 6.6 per cent.

NOT HAWK OR DOVE

Addressing the post-policy

Sanguine outlook

Growth projections inch higher

Real GDP growth projections (in %)	Apr MPC	June MPC	Aug MPC
Q1 2026-27	6.8	6.6	7.0
Q2 2026-27	6.7	6.3	6.4
Q3 2026-27	7.0	6.5	6.5
Q4 2026-27	7.2	6.5	6.8
2026-27	6.9	6.6	6.7

Status quo on repo rate (in %)



Source: RBI

Inflation forecast more benign

CPI inflation projections (in %)	Apr MPC	June MPC	Aug MPC
Q1 2026-27	4.0	4.2	3.9
Q2 2026-27	4.4	5.1	4.7
Q3 2026-27	5.2	5.9	5.9
Q4 2026-27	4.7	5.4	5.5
2026-27	4.6	5.1	5.0



press conference, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said the central bank does not see itself as either dovish or hawkish.

"We feel that this is the right policy rate for the growth-inflation dynamics that we are in today and the outlook that we have projected. There is a lot of uncertainty, which will, of course, play out. The monetary policy framework is very clear. I don't think there should be any confusion about the framework. Our

target is headline inflation. It is not core inflation, excluding precious metals. We will continue to be guided by headline inflation, and it is our endeavour to bring headline inflation in line with the 4 per cent target."

Malhotra said the projected rise in inflation is expected to stem largely from food and fuel-related supply-side pressures rather than broad-based demand pressures. He added that while economic growth remains resilient, it is likely to moderate in FY27.

WEATHER ISSUES

The RBI Governor stressed that uncertainties surrounding weather conditions, geopolitics and global trade warrant caution before any policy action is considered.

Any future move, he said, would need to reflect evolving growth-inflation dynamics and the normalisation of underlying inflation.

Despite the slight reduction in the RBI's FY27 forecast, inflation is expected to remain above 5 per cent for much of the year. The central bank projects CPI inflation to peak at 5.9 per cent in the third quarter (October-December), close to the MPC's upper tolerance limit of 6 per cent, before easing to 5.5 per cent in the fourth quarter (January-March).

Economists remain divided on the likely policy response if inflation remains elevated. Gaura Sengupta, Chief Economist at IDFC First Bank, said, "The RBI's constructive growth outlook and easing inflation risks support an extended pause in rates through FY27."

More reports p3

With LIC OFS fetching ₹31,000 cr, government gets two-thirds of FY27 'Miscellaneous Receipts' BE

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

With the completion of LIC's offer for sale (OFS) on Wednesday, the money collected by the Centre under the 'Miscellaneous Receipts' head touched nearly two-thirds of the Budget Estimate for FY27, taking the proceeds from disinvestments to the highest in eight years.

The government off-loaded 6.54 per cent in the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) and got over ₹31,000 crore. With this, the total proceeds under disinvestment crossed ₹52,000 crore, which is the highest after 2018-19, when the mop-up was around ₹85,000 crore.

STAKE-SALES

Notably, the term 'disinvestment' is no longer part of the Budget document, with proceeds from stake-sales included under the 'Miscellaneous Receipts' for which the FY27 BE is ₹80,000 crore.

This head also includes earnings from asset monetisation. The LIC OFS was in two phases. On August 4,



non-retail investors responded overwhelmingly, and the OFS was subscribed 3.32 times its base size.

GREENSHOE OPTION

Based on that, the government decided to exercise the greenshoe option of offloading 4 per cent, taking the total stake offloaded to 6.54 per cent (including 50 lakh or 0.04 per cent stake for employees).

Retail investors and eligible employees got to bid (after considering a discount of ₹10 per equity share) at ₹373.10 a piece. The cut-off price for the non-retail investors remained unchanged at ₹383.10.

The OFS helped the LIC achieve the minimum public shareholding (MPS) norm ahead of schedule.

The revised timeline for achieving 10 per cent public shareholding was on or before May 16, 2027. The public holding, now at 3.5 per cent, will go up to 10 per cent post the OFS.

According to DIPAM Secretary Arunish Chawla, LIC is the cornerstone of the country's financial sector, serving as India's largest life insurer and the country's second-largest public sector enterprise by market capitalisation.

"OFS in the LIC closed with an overwhelming response from both retail and institutional investors. The issue was oversubscribed on both days and the government exercised its entire green shoe option. With this, the public ownership of LIC has increased to 10 per cent and it has achieved this critical milestone ahead of schedule. A total of 82,23,33,558 shares have been allocated for an amount of ₹31,552 crore, making it India's largest public offering ever. We thank all the investors for their enthusiastic participation and reposing their faith in us," Chawla said in a social media post.

FLAG OF FREEDOM



SYMBOL OF STRUGGLE. Workers in a Surat factory give final touches to the Tricolour ahead of preparations for Independence Day celebrations. On August 15, India will complete 79 years of freedom, celebrating the 80th Independence Day commemorating decades of struggle and sacrifice by leaders, revolutionaries and ordinary citizens to end 200 years of British colonial rule. **ANI**

Tata Sons expected to continue as upper-layer NBFC

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Tata Sons is expected to continue as an upper-layer non-banking financial company under the RBI's scale-based regulatory framework, with Governor Sanjay Malhotra indicating the classification remains principle-based and will continue to be governed by prescribed criteria.

Responding to a query on whether Tata Sons would remain on the upper-layer list, the Governor emphasised that the framework no longer hinges on entity-specific decisions, but on regulatory principles.

"It is now principle-based. So, as per those principles, everyone knows what is the list and that is where the matter stands," said Malhotra.

Read more p3

Youth, women welfare at centre of TVK's first TN Budget; eyes \$1.5 trillion economy by 2035

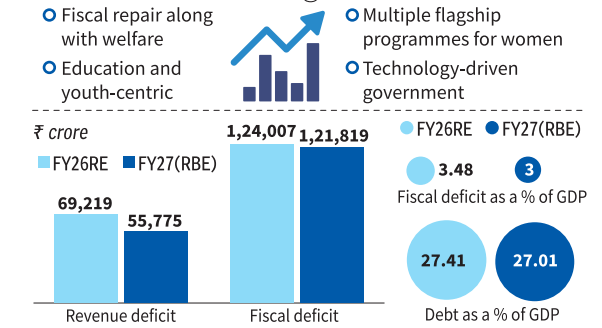
Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

The maiden Budget of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) government in Tamil Nadu, presented on Wednesday, attempted to balance welfare spending and long-term investments in infrastructure development with fiscal prudence.

Finance Minister N Marie Wilson's Budget speech, lasting almost two-and-a-half hours, focused on women and youth, with schemes including gold for brides and newborns, laptops, expansion of the breakfast scheme, and revamp of government schools. Many of these schemes carried the *Vetri* tag, in line with the government's identity.

The Budget batted for

TVK's maiden Budget



tech-enabled transformation both in industrial ecosystem and governance. AI, semiconductors and deep-tech got special focus and the goal to reach \$1.5 trillion by 2035 was supported through new policies, industrial parks and green energy push.

While previous Budgets devoted significant attention to investment projects, the

TVK edition seems to take the view that improving governance and quality of living will lead to economic growth.

Wilson stressed that the State is in the red, and they had been "handed a treasury box that is overburdened with debt" and is leaking. "The repair has started, but it will need at least two years

to bring the financial administration back to the track of fiscal prudence," he said.

Political opponents, however, said the Budget lacked vision, failed on election promises, and was merely rebranding past initiatives.

OWN TAX REVENUE

The Budget estimated a lower Own Tax Revenue at ₹2,26,740 crore for FY27, down ₹2,839 crore from the Interim Budget Estimate.

"The erosion is not due to any structural weakness in the economy but due to administrative decline and systemic leakages," Wilson said.

However, OTR growth is pegged at 14 per cent in FY28 and FY29. Revenue expenditure shows an increase of 3.19 per cent over the Interim Budget.

Also read p11

Govt warns Meta could lose safe harbour protection; firm apologises for lapses

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Meta has apologised for the temporary removal of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Facebook post as also for other issues, including child sexual abuse content and deepfakes.

Simultaneously, the government put Meta on notice that it could lose legal safe harbour protections available to online intermediaries, arguing the social media giant could not claim to be a "neutral" platform when its algorithms actively curate, recommend and determine the content users receive.

Senior executives of the American tech behemoth met Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw and IT Secretary S Krishnan on Wednesday.

Meta's Global Affairs Head Joel Kaplan said in a written statement, "I apolo-



Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg

gised to the Minister on behalf of Meta for the error-restricting PM Modi's post."

DEEPAKE CONTENT

Government sources said that Meta chief Mark Zuckerberg conveyed his apologies over issues concerning CSAM and deepfake content and errors in platform operations. Under the Information Technology Act and the Information Technology Guidelines

and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, social media platforms enjoy "safe harbour" protection from liability for third-party content, provided they function as neutral intermediaries and comply with due diligence obligations prescribed under the law.

Government sources, however, said Meta's algorithm-driven curation and recommendation of content meant it could no longer claim to be merely an intermediary and would, therefore, not be entitled to such legal protection.

Sources said the Centre made it clear Meta could not claim the status of a "neutral" intermediary as its platform algorithms actively curate, recommend and determine which users receive what content. On that basis, the government argued it would not be entitled to the safe harbour protec-

tions available to intermediaries. Sources also said Meta officials admitted to failures in checking child sexual abuse content and deepfakes, and acknowledged that "a lot of money was paid for boosting a certain type of content", expressing regret over the lapse.

PAID PROMOTIONS

Meta also admitted that a significant amount of illegal content was promoted and that paid promotions were carried out for specific audiences, government sources said, adding that the company had been told it will be summoned again for further discussions.

Kaplan was summoned by the government to explain the temporary removal of PM Modi's July 23 Facebook post, in which he addressed students and promised stringent action against examination paper leaks.

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

Air India has named Tewolde Gebremariam as its Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director, succeeding Campbell Wilson.

Just weeks ago, he was the front-runner to be named the CEO of Pakistan International Airlines (PIA). However, his appointment was never formally announced.

GLOBAL SEARCH

On Wednesday, the Air India Board of Directors approved Gebremariam's appointment, following what the airline described as a comprehensive global search overseen by a dedicated board committee, which evaluated both internal and external candidates.

The details relating to Gebremariam's onboarding and transition timeline will be announced separately.



Tewolde Gebremariam

which the airline's revenues quadrupled while its fleet nearly tripled.

Gebremariam also brings extensive experience in developing long-haul international networks, building global hub operations, expanding maintenance, repair and overhaul capabilities, and establishing aviation training infrastructure.

Air India said the leadership transition comes as the airline moves beyond its initial stabilisation and integration phase towards execu-

tion, international expansion and long-term profitability.

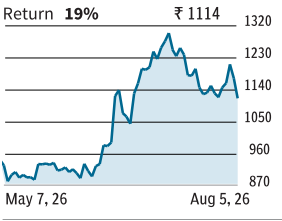
According to N Chandrasekaran, Chairman of Tata Sons and Air India, "Having completed the initial phase of stabilisation, integration and fleet commitments under Campbell Wilson's guidance, Air India is now entering a critical execution and expansion era."

Gebremariam's expertise, commitment to safety and experience in developing global aviation hubs would be instrumental in positioning Air India as a premier international airline.

On his part, Gebremariam said it was a privilege to lead Air India at a significant stage in its evolution. The airline would focus on operational reliability, customer service and sustainable long-term growth while supporting India's emergence as a major global aviation market, he said.

QUICKLY.

Rane (Madras) Q1 profit rises 63% in Q1FY27



Chennai: Rane (Madras), the Chennai-based auto component manufacturer, reported a 63 per cent increase in consolidated net profit to ₹30 crore for Q1FY27, as against ₹19 crore in the same quarter last year. Total revenue rose 19 per cent to ₹1,051 crore (₹884 crore). Sales to domestic OE customers grew 13 per cent, mainly due to higher offtake in the passenger vehicle and farm tractor segment. Sales to international customers increased 24 per cent, supported by strong offtake of steering products. Sales to Indian Aftermarket customers increased 28 per cent, said a release. During Q1, the company incurred capex of ₹76 crore, a majority of which was directed towards steering and linkages, and brake components divisions. **OUR BUREAU**

Marico aims to cross ₹15,000 cr by FY27-end, profitable growth central to its strategy

KEY HEADWIND. Inflationary pressures will continue to play out in Q2 as volatility is likely to stay, says its MD and CEO

bl.interview

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Marico has set its sights on crossing the ₹15,000-crore revenue-mark by FY27-end. The FMCG major said the focus will not just be on topline growth but also improving the profitability profile of foods and digital-first brands portfolio. Saugata Gupta, MD & CEO, Marico, said while inflationary pressures will continue to playout in Q2, the company is reasonably well-positioned to sustain healthy rural growth. *Edited excerpts:*

What's your view on the overall consumption outlook as well as on rural growth? The sector has been delivering stronger growth since Q3

following the GST rationalisation. The June quarter presented a mix of both tailwinds and headwinds. Provided there are no major inflationary shocks, we expect consumption trends to remain reasonably stable. Naturally, some inflationary pressures will continue to play out in Q2, and we should be prepared to witness slightly-elevated crude levels even in the next few quarters, as volatility is likely to stay. Historically, larger players have been better positioned to navigate such disruptions than the smaller competitors. While we remain watchful of the external environment, we are not overly concerned at this stage.

In terms of rural growth, we are closely monitoring how the monsoon plays out, which could have an impact in the second half of the year. Unless there is significant deficiency in rainfall, we believe

While we remain watchful of the external environment, we are not overly concerned at this stage

SAUGATA GUPTA
MD and CEO, Marico



lieve we are reasonably well-positioned to sustain healthy rural growth. For us, both urban and rural general trade channels have delivered double-digit growth. A key contributor to our strong rural performance has been Project Setu, which focuses on improving the quality of direct distribution and investing in technology-led rural distribution capabilities.

Will you continue to look at inorganic

Audi India aims to double market share to 16% in 3 years

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Audi has set its sights on a 16 per cent share of the Indian luxury car market within three years, up from its current 8 per cent. A top company official revealed plans for aggressive network expansion and new model launches to compete with dominant players Mercedes-Benz and BMW.

The company will launch three new products in the next one year, starting with the all-new Q3 sports utility vehicle (SUV) this festival season, followed by electric



Balbir Singh Dhillon, Brand Director, Audi India *KS*

car E5 by first half of next year and its flagship model Audi Q9 by the second half of the next year.

“We are in the cusp of launching one of the

strongest products offensive. We have been working on three pillars for the last couple of months — new products and focus will remain in ‘Make in India’; second is the network; and the third pillar will be the customers engagement after they own the cars. The ultimate objective of all of these three topics is that we want to double our market share in the next three years, which is currently at around 8 per cent,” Balbir Singh Dhillon, Brand Director, Audi India, told *businessline*.

STRONGER NETWORK
On the network side, Dhillon

side it will be expanded to around 40 showrooms by next year from 29, continuing with ‘workshops first’ strategy and ‘Audi Approved’ for repairs and selling pre-owned cars respectively.

“We are doing some massive skill upgradation programme for the workforce too because all the new products will come with the new, latest technology including many features, which we will introduce for the first time. All the cars will be software-heavy, a lot of digital elements inside the cars, which we will see for the first time, and also Advanced Driver Assistance

Systems,” he said.

On other alternate fuel options, Dhillon said the company will focus on petrol and EVs right now, and depending on the India-EU free trade agreement, Audi can always import some of the strong hybrids to the Indian shores.

On the luxury car market in India, he said the market is expected to remain flat this year because of several reasons including West Asia war and the forex fluctuations. The luxury car market in India stood at around 52,000 units in 2025, which is estimated to be around 55,000 units this year.

Persistent Systems’ Nagarro buy gets shareholders’ nod

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Shareholders of IT services company Persistent Systems approved the acquisition of Nagarro SE through its subsidiary Galaxy Germany Holding SE at Persistent’s Annual General Meeting.

As shareholders favour the move with a requisite majority, the company flagged all offer details to be laid out shortly. This formal Offer Document, setting out the full terms and conditions of the cash offer, will be published on the Galaxy website following approval by the German Federal Financial Supervisory Authority. Nagarro shareholders and other interested parties are encouraged to review all documentation relating to the offer, as it becomes available on the website, said the company in a release.

The new entity will focus on scaled, globally diversified AI-led digital engineering and enterprise modernisation, having presence in North America and Europe and exposure in other global markets.

lished on the Galaxy website following approval by the German Federal Financial Supervisory Authority. Nagarro shareholders and other interested parties are encouraged to review all documentation relating to the offer, as it becomes available on the website, said the company in a release.

The new entity will focus on scaled, globally diversified AI-led digital engineering and enterprise modernisation, having presence in North America and Europe and exposure in other global markets.

River gears up for multi-product play after \$120 m fundraise

Jyoti Banthia Venkatesha Babu
Bengaluru

Electric two-wheeler maker River Mobility is expanding beyond its single-product strategy with plans to launch two new electric scooters, including a more affordable model, as it looks to scale volumes and strengthen its position in India’s fast-growing EV market.

The Bengaluru-based start-up, which on Tuesday announced a \$120-million Series C funding round led by Elev8 Venture Partners and Claypond Capital, said the first of the new scooters will be launched by mid-2027.

While both products will remain within River’s utility lifestyle positioning, they will cater to different price-points.

“The first product will roll out in the middle of 2027. Both products will be in the utility lifestyle category, but the pricing will be different. One of the products will be a

slightly lower-priced EV scooter,” Co-founder and Chief Executive Aravind Mani told *businessline*.

The move marks River’s first portfolio expansion since it launched the Indie scooter in 2023. The broader portfolio is expected to help River target a wider customer base at a time when incumbent manufacturers such as TVS Motor, Bajaj Auto and Hero MotoCorp, along with start-ups, including Ather Energy and Ola Electric, are expanding their EV line-ups.

NEW FACILITY
River is also preparing for a major manufacturing scale-up.

The company plans to begin construction of a greenfield factory within the next two months, which will significantly expand production capacity beyond its existing plant on the outskirts of Bengaluru.

“We are starting work on the next factory in the next 45-60 days. That is going to be a greenfield development.



Both products will be in the utility lifestyle category, but the pricing will be different

ARAVIND MANI
Co-founder and Chief Executive, River Mobility

We are looking for a capacity of around seven-eight times the current capacity,” Mani said.

“We want to get the first phase operational in around 10-12 months.”

River’s current factory has

a monthly production capacity of 10,000 units and is already nearing its limits as sales continue to rise. The company said it sold around 6,000 vehicles last month and expects to cross 7,000 units this month, while planning to expand its retail footprint to about 200 stores by March 2027.

The fresh capital will fund the new facility, new product development and expansion of its distribution network. Mani said around 30-40 per cent of the proceeds will be allocated towards the factory, research and development, and future products, while the overall investment in the new facility is expected to be \$50-60 million over the next three-four years.

PROFITABILITY GOAL
As it scales, the company is also targeting profitability. River expects to achieve EBITDA break-even once monthly sales reach around 25,000 units.

“The EBITDA profitability will happen at around 25,000 units a month. Today, we are

at around 6,000-7,000 units a month,” Mani said, adding that higher production volumes, greater vertical integration and supplier efficiencies would improve margins.

On the policy front, Mani said Delhi’s proposed electric vehicle policy, which seeks to accelerate EV adoption by discouraging new petrol-powered two-wheelers, could become a template for other States.

“I think other States will follow soon,” he said.

However, Mani said newer EV manufacturers continue to be disadvantaged under the existing Production Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme, which largely benefits larger incumbents.

“The only ask is a level-playing field. It cannot be that there are five companies out there who get a PLI benefit, creating a 12-13 per cent cost advantage compared to players like us,” he said, adding that the company has made representations to the Centre to widen the scheme’s eligibility.

Berger Paints Q1 PAT up 28.6 per cent

Our Bureau
Kolkata

Paints major Berger Paints reported a 28.6 per cent year-on-year increase in its consolidated net profit to ₹405.01 crore for Q1 FY27, backed by around 12 per cent rise in revenue. It posted a net profit of ₹315.04 crore in the year-ago quarter.

Its revenue from operations rose to ₹3,583.75 crore (₹3,200.76 crore). EBITDA, excluding other income, was ₹607.4 crore (₹528.4 crore), an increase of 15 per cent. Consolidated PBDIT margin expanded around 40 basis points.

“The progressive demand improvement seen in the previous quarter continued into the first quarter of the year which enabled the achievement of a standalone value growth of 12.7 per cent for the quarter. The value growth outpaced volume growth on the back of the price increases with the full benefit to accrue, going forward. Our performance this

Scorecard <i>(in ₹ cr)</i>			
	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	y-o-y % change
Net profit	315.04	405.01	28.56
Revenue from operations	3,200.76	3,583.75	11.96
Total expenses	2,780.81	3,091.83	11.18

quarter was driven by strong growth both in Automotive and Decorative segments,” said Abhijit Roy, Managing Director and CEO, Berger Paints India.

POSTIVE START
Roy said it was a positive start to the new year despite the unsettled environment resulting from the conflict in West Asia, which led to disruptions in the availability and prices of crude and impacted crude-based raw materials.

“This inflation in crude-based materials led to some moderation in our gross margins. However, prudent financial control and improved efficiencies led to an operating profit margin slightly ahead of the guidance range and a strong PAT growth in excess of 25 per

cent on a standalone basis and 29 per cent on consolidated basis,” he said.

The company said its joint ventures continued to deliver strong growth in both revenue and profitability. Bolix, a wholly-owned subsidiary, reported flattish revenue during the quarter due to seasonal factors. However, profitability improved, driven by gross margin expansion. The UK operations remained subdued.

On the business outlook for the current fiscal, Berger Paints said double-digit revenue growth is expected to sustain, supported by the full-quarter impact of price increases in Q2, festival demand and distribution expansion.

Operating margins are expected to remain within the guided range.

Freshworks beats guidance, posts 16% revenue growth in Q2 2026

Rohan Das
Chennai

Software-as-a-service firm Freshworks on Wednesday beat its own revenue estimates for the quarter ended June 2026 (Q2) by reporting a 16 per cent growth in revenue at \$237.4 million, as against \$204.7 million in the year-ago quarter. On a constant currency basis, revenue growth was at 15 per cent.

The Nasdaq-listed company posted a GAAP net profit of \$3.2 million as against a loss of \$1.7 million in Q2 2025. Freshworks follows a calendar year reporting format.

The firm, with a significant presence in Chennai, increased full-year guidance for 2026 to 15 per cent from 14-15 per cent. For the third

The company posted a GAAP net profit of \$3.2 million as against a loss of \$1.7 million in Q2 2025

quarter ending September 2026, it expects to grow at 14 per cent. In an investor call, Dennis Woodside, CEO and President, said the firm is seeing increased momentum and pipeline of deals in the employee experience (EX) vertical. “Given our product strategy and the go-to-market strategy coming together, we have confidence that we have cracked the code on pipeline. A year ago, we were a little bit more challenged around pipelines

but this year in both the first and second second quarter, we did really well in generating new pipelines. That pipeline is maturing and is coming due in the second half of the year. That gives us confidence.”

EX BIZ GROWTH
He said the company’s EX business is set to contribute nearly 60 per cent of its overall topline by the year-end, significantly higher than the 35 per cent in 2021 when it went public.

Tyler Sloat, Chief Operating Officer and CFO, said that the EX vertical ended Q2 reporting Annual Recurring Revenue (ARR) at \$567 million, growing 23 per cent year-over-year, while its Customer Experience ARR ended Q2 at \$400 million, growing 3 per cent.

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

International aerospace major Rolls-Royce expects India to emerge as a globally-competitive manufacturing base for advanced aero-engine components over the next five years as the company expands its supplier ecosystem and deepens the integration of Indian manufacturers into its global supply chains.

Speaking to *businessline*, Sashi Mukundan, Executive Vice-President – Transformation, Rolls-Royce India, said the company sees Indian industry progressively developing capabilities in manufacturing high-value compressor and turbine components, rotating parts, complex machined structures and advanced

aerospace manufacturing processes.

Notably, the expansion forms part of Rolls-Royce’s broader plan to increase sourcing from India to around \$1 billion over the next five years. This reflects the company’s long-term objective of making India a strategic manufacturing and engineering hub for its global civil aerospace, defence and power systems businesses.

ECOSYSTEM CREATION
“Our ambitions for India also include the creation of a complete, sovereign aero-engine ecosystem, at the heart of which is a dedicated Aero Gas Turbine Complex that we are proposing to set up in the country, with the AMCA programme as an anchor,” Mukundan said.



According to him, strengthening India’s manufacturing ecosystem, both in terms of scale and technological capability, is fundamental to supporting the company’s long-term aero-engine programmes, while enabling India to play a larger role in global aerospace supply chains.

Besides expanding component manufacturing, Rolls-Royce expects India to strengthen capabilities in areas such as quality man-

agement systems, regulatory approvals, certification processes and advanced materials handling.

Furthermore, Mukundan said the company’s objective extends beyond increasing sourcing volumes and instead is focused on developing long-term industrial capability through technology partnerships, knowledge transfer and supplier development.

He said the recent visit of Rolls-Royce Group Chief Procurement and Supply Chain Officer Martin Thomson to India underlined the company’s commitment to strengthening relationships with existing suppliers while identifying new partners capable of supporting future global programmes.

As per the company, the expansion of the supplier

ecosystem is expected to improve supply-chain resilience while supporting India’s ambition of building an internationally-competitive aerospace manufacturing base under the Viksit Bharat vision.

Currently, Rolls-Royce works with several Indian companies, including Hindustan Aeronautics (HAL), Bharat Forge, Tata, Godrej, Force Motors and Azad Engineering.

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TECH DIGEST.

ChatGPT Voice brings conversation into daily life

OpenAI is showcasing new ways users can leverage ChatGPT Voice, powered by GPT-Live, to handle learning, productivity and communication tasks through natural conversations. The feature is designed to support spoken interactions, allowing users to speak freely,



interrupt, clarify points and switch between languages during a conversation. The voice experience can assist with a range of activities, from interview preparation and language learning to organising work and managing personal responsibilities. The tool can also support interactive learning by asking follow-up questions, providing hints and adapting explanations based on a user's level of understanding. For multilingual users, ChatGPT Voice can help translate and refine spoken input into different formats, such as professional emails, complaints or conversations tailored to specific situations. OpenAI highlighted potential use cases in India, where many users regularly switch between languages in day-to-day communication. The company also positions the feature as a productivity tool for entrepreneurs and professionals.

POCO unveils M8 Power ahead of August 7 sale in India

POCO has launched the M8 Power in India, featuring an 8,000mAh silicon-carbon battery, a 120Hz AMOLED display and



Qualcomm's Snapdragon 4 Gen 4 processor. The smartphone runs Xiaomi HyperOS 3 based on Android 16 and is positioned in the mid-range segment.

Battery life is a key focus, with the 8,000mAh battery supporting 45 W wired fast charging and 22.5 W reverse wired charging, allowing the phone to be used for charging compatible accessories and other devices. For photography, the M8 Power includes a 50 MP rear camera and an 8 MP front-facing camera, along with AI-assisted imaging and content creation features. The smartphone is available with 6 GB or 8 GB of RAM and 128 GB of storage, with support for expandable storage via a microSD card. Connectivity options include 5G, dual-band Wi-Fi, Bluetooth 5.1 and an IR blaster, with an IP65 rating. The POCO M8 Power is available in 6 GB + 128 GB and 8 GB + 128 GB variants, priced ₹24,999 and ₹27,999. Sales are scheduled to begin in India from August 7.

Sony expands Bravia with 115-inch flagship TV in India

Sony India has expanded its Bravia television range with the introduction of the 115-inch (292 cm) Bravia 9iL, the largest television in the company's Bravia portfolio. The launch extends Sony's premium TV lineup, which now spans screen sizes from 55 inches to 115 inches.



The Bravia 9iL is based on Sony's RGB Backlight Master Drive Pro technology, which independently controls red, green and blue LEDs to improve colour reproduction, contrast and brightness. The television also includes the Bravia XR Processor, Sony's image-processing engine. The 115-inch model features a 12-speaker acoustic multi-audio+ system, comprising two subwoofers, eight full-range speakers and two tweeters. Sony says the setup is designed to improve audio localisation and dialogue clarity for large-screen viewing. The 115-inch Bravia 9iL is priced ₹45,99,900 (MRP), with a listed best-buy price of ₹28,99,990, and will be available in India soon. The remaining Bravia 9iL and Bravia 7iL models are already on sale through Sony retail stores.

Apple gears up for iPhone launch with employee lottery

With Apple Inc gearing up for its biggest product launch of the year, the company is opening a lottery for US retail employees



who want to help staff with the in-person unveiling. The lottery allows retail employees to work in the event, where they will help organise lines, check in guests, greet attendees, offer directions and support the security teams, according to a memo that was seen by Bloomberg News. The launch event will take place during the first half of September, the company told staff, without providing a more specific date. Historically, Apple's iPhone presentations have taken place on the second Tuesday or Wednesday of that month. Since Labour Day in the US falls on Monday, September 7, a Wednesday event appears slightly more likely, as it would preserve the workday travel window Apple has historically provided for attendees. In the memo, Apple said it was "excited to offer US store team members the opportunity to participate in the Event Support Experience Programme".

Moto shifts gears to performance overdrive

MOTOROLA EDGE 70 MAX. Designed for your need for speed with a massive battery and Snapdragon 8 Gen 5 chipset

Ashwin Rajagopalan

The contrast couldn't be more stark. Barely a month ago, we were heaping praise on the Motorola Edge 70 Pro+ for its sleek design and lightweight form factor. The follow-up device in the same product line marks a departure of sorts for Motorola in its pursuit for speed. The name is a giveaway: the Edge 70 Max chases performance to the max. It lands in a price segment where other performance-focused smartphones from brands like OnePlus and iQOO are already slugging it out. Does the Edge 70 Max have the firepower for this showdown?

DESIGN

Nowhere is the gap more glaring than the form factor. If the Edge 70 Pro and Pro+ were all about an elegant, almost chic aesthetic, this is clearly a performance-forward smartphone. It deviates from the curves that defined the Edge 70 series, opting instead for a flat-frame. This is not a bad thing. It is thicker and, at 221 g, approximately 10 per cent heavier than the Edge 70 Pro+. The Max version still feels good in your hand, thanks to weight distribution. I am sure it will comfort hardcore gamers who need to cling on to their devices for longer.

The Edge 70 Max opts for a subtle set of Pantone-certified colour ways. Motorola shipped us the Aqua Gray, where grey meets olive green, that is probably the pick of the three colours you can buy. I like the matte finish that ensures the device repels fingerprints and smudges. Just like the Edge 70 Pro, the device comes with IP68 and IP69 ratings, along with MIL-STD-810H military-grade certification for shock-proofing.

DISPLAY

This is by no means a showdown, but I enjoyed watching content a lot more on the Edge 70 Max than the 70 Pro+. The display is one of the key focus areas for the Max version, enhancing its appeal as a device for gaming marathons. I was already impressed with the punchy colours on the Edge 70 Pro+, but the Edge 70 Max takes it further with a higher QHD+ resolution.



AESTHETIC APPEAL. A sophisticated design with just 221 g and Hello UI performance can provide effortless performance for regular usage ASHWIN RAJAGOPALAN

The 6.8-inch extreme AMOLED display (1440 x 3168 pixels / 510 PPI) peaks at 7000 nits with a high brightness mode on 2100 nits. The colours are gorgeous with a refresh rate up to 144 Hz. I watched a whole episode of the second season of *The Agency* on this display, and it aced the contrasting landscapes and lighting scenarios of London and Antwerp. Just like the Edge 70 Pro+, I stuck with the vivid colour option. You also get a natural and radiant display mode. I preferred the flat display in the Max to the curved displays that we have seen on the Edge 70 series, but this might boil down to a personal preference.

PERFORMANCE

This is where the Edge 70 Max truly shines. The device is powered by a Snapdragon 8 Gen 5 chipset. Motorola offers this device in an 8 GB/256 GB and a 12 GB/256 GB storage option. We checked out the 8 GB variant that blazed through our gaming and benchmark tests. Scores on the Geekbench (multi-

core) benchmark test consistently hovered around the 9000 mark, which is impressive in this price segment.

Just like the other devices in the Edge 70 series, the Max version runs on Hello UI. We like the clean design aesthetic, but our cribs still remain — pre-installed apps and the Android OS update policy. You only get three years of Android updates and five years of security updates, which seems subpar for a device at this price tag and at a time when most of us are looking at holding on to our smartphones for longer.

BATTERY

Motorola's Edge 70 series have made the right moves on the battery front. The Max version is no exception. The large 7100 mAh battery is more than an acceptable trade-off for all that extra left. Motorola tells us that this device can clock up to 42 hours of continuous video playback. While that is not a number that I was able to verify, the

device is clearly an endurance runner in the battery segment. It lasted almost two days for each charging cycle during my time with the device. For most average users, it could well be a two-day battery, giving it a clear edge over many of its rivals.

The 90 W in-box 'TurboPower' charger powers this device in quick time — 1 to 50 per cent in just over 20 minutes. It is not just wired charging that is a win, the device offers 25 W wireless Q2.2 charging that is great to have in the sub ₹55,000 price segment.

CAMERA

The priorities of the Edge 70 Max become evident once you switch to camera mode. It lacks a telephoto lens that I enjoyed using on the 70 Pro+. The primary lens (50 MP / Sony Lytia 710) with an f/1.8 aperture is similar to the one I checked out on the Edge 70 Pro+, but the 8 MP ultra-wide lens is not in the same league as the 50 MP lens on the Pro+. The Max version shoots

crisp images and videos in optimal light and does a reasonably good job in low light and with portrait images. However, the low light performance of the ultra-wide camera does not quite measure up.

VERDICT

The Motorola Edge 70 Max might be new territory for Motorola but it certainly does not struggle for direction. It ticks the key boxes that matter to its target audience — raw power, battery life and a display with vibrant colours. If performance is your key purchase driver, then the Edge 70 Max is a compelling option at its asking price.

● SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹54,999 onwards
Pros: Battery life, overall performance, immersive display, wireless charging
Cons: Only three years of Android OS updates, ultra-wide camera

A battery champion with muscle to match

ASUS ZENBOOK A14. Does it finally make ARM-powered Windows laptops a serious mainstream choice?

Siddharth Mathew Cherian

The Asus ZenBook range has been the mainstream subject for Asus in the premium notebook segment for close to a decade now, and as one which works well for students, office users and customers of premium laptops alike. The ASUS ZenBook A14, powered by a Snapdragon chip, landed on my desk for review, and I was curious to see whether its promise of exceptional battery life and ARM-powered performance could live up to the hype.

DESIGN

The ZenBook A14 carries forward the understated, minimalist design language that has become synonymous with the ZenBook range. This time around, ASUS has introduced its Ceraluminum finish (ceramicised magnesium-aluminium alloy), which gives the chassis a reassuringly solid feel while retaining its lightweight nature. The Iceland Grey matte finish does an excellent job of keeping fingerprints and smudges to a minimum, helping the laptop maintain its clean, premium look even with regular use.

Weighing just 0.99 kg, the ASUS ZenBook A14 sets the benchmark for portability in the premium laptop segment. It feels remarkably light in daily use and slips into a backpack without adding noticeable weight. Having reviewed several metal and aluminium-built laptops in the past, the A14 stands out for striking an excellent balance between durability and portability, making it an ideal companion for students, professionals and frequent travellers alike.

DISPLAY

The ASUS ZenBook A14 features a 14-inch ASUS Lumina OLED display with a Full HD+ (1920 x 1200) resolution and a 16:10 aspect ratio. The OLED panel delivers vibrant colours, deep blacks and excellent contrast, resulting in an immersive viewing experience. It also offers a 0.2 ms response time, a 60 Hz refresh rate, 400 nits of typical brightness, and up to 600 nits of HDR



PREMIUM SCREEN. The ASUS ZenBook A14 features a stunning 14-inch ASUS Lumina OLED display with a Full HD+ (1920 x 1200) resolution and a 16:10 aspect ratio BIJOY GHOSH

peak brightness, making it well-suited for entertainment, creative workloads and professional use.

The display was a lot like fine wine. Vibrant colours and deep blacks came to the fore while watching the Tamil crime comedy *Con City* on Netflix, where the golden hues of the set pieces and the cast's skin tones came across particularly well on this display. Sadly, for the price, ASUS has opted for a 60 Hz panel. While this does not take away much from the ZenBook A14 as an Ultrabook, it does prevent the display from feeling truly exceptional for gaming, content creation and other visually intensive workloads, especially considering the premium price tag.

SOUND

The ASUS ZenBook A14 features dual super-linear speakers, which at first glance seem well-equipped for enjoying music, movies and multimedia content. *Sadda Haq* from *Rockstar* might seem like an unlikely track to test the speakers, but it proved to be a solid benchmark.

What stood out was the speaker system's ability to maintain clarity even at higher volume levels. Vocals remained crisp, and the background instrumentation wasn't drowned out as the volume increased. For those who enjoy unwinding with music, web series or

movies, the ZenBook A14 speakers are more than capable of delivering an enjoyable listening experience.

The ASUS ZenBook A14 offers a versatile selection of ports that cater to most productivity and connectivity needs. On the left side, the laptop houses two USB 4.0 Gen 3 Type-C ports, supporting data transfer speeds of up to 40 Gbps, DisplayPort output, and Power Delivery charging. There is also an HDMI 2.1 port for connecting external displays and a 3.5 mm combo audio jack for headphones and headsets. On the right side, ASUS has included a USB 3.2 Gen 2 Type-A port with data transfer speeds of up to 10 Gbps, ensuring compatibility with a wide range of peripherals, accessories and storage devices. While the overall port selection is adequate for a modern ultraportable, the addition of a USB-C port on the right side would have improved convenience and flexibility, particularly when connecting external displays, docking stations or chargers from either side of the laptop.

PERFORMANCE

At the heart of the ZenBook A14 review unit is Qualcomm's flagship Snapdragon X Elite X2E88100 processor, featuring 18 cores and 18 threads. Paired with 16 GB of RAM and 512 GB of storage, the ZenBook



A14 proves itself to be a highly capable Ultrabook within ASUS' Snapdragon-powered line-up. ASUS also offers variants powered by the Snapdragon X1-26-100 processor (30 MB cache, up to 2.97 GHz, 8 cores and 8 threads), which should be well-suited to students and college goers looking for a balance between performance and affordability.

In synthetic benchmarks, the ZenBook A14 posted impressive results. In Cinebench 2026, it scored 572 points in the CPU Single Thread test, placing it eighth in the rankings, while its CPU Multi Thread score of 4,847 points secured fifth place. More notably, it outperformed several desktop-class processors, including the AMD Ryzen Threadripper 2990WX, highlighting the level of performance Qualcomm's Snapdragon X Elite platform is capable of delivering in a thin-and-light form factor.

I was able to squeeze in some gaming, and the laptop managed to hold a steady 60 fps with minimal frame drops. Thermal management was equally impressive, with the laptop remaining cool and quiet during everyday tasks. Even under sustained workloads and stress tests, the fan noise was kept well under control and was only mildly audible. Using Adobe Premiere Pro, I exported a 14-minute interview video containing B-roll footage and

After Effects compositions in under five minutes at half-resolution preview settings. This makes the ASUS ZenBook A14 a surprisingly capable machine for editing 1080 p content on the move — a compelling option for professionals who prefer to travel light without sacrificing productivity.

BATTERY

The ASUS ZenBook A14 is powered by a 70 Wh Li-ion battery, and battery life is easily one of the laptop's strongest attributes. In my usage, which included web browsing, video streaming, music playback and light social media management, the laptop consistently delivered between 15 and 17 hours on a single charge. With lighter workloads focused primarily on browsing and document work, I was able to push battery life closer to 23 to 24 hours.

Given how much I enjoyed the display, a fair amount of my time with the ZenBook A14 was spent editing videos. Charging speeds were equally respectable. The bundled 100 W charger took the battery from 0 to 100 per cent in roughly two hours. The ZenBook A14 also supports fast charging, allowing it to reach around 60 per cent in under an hour, making quick top-ups convenient when time is limited.

VERDICT

While the 60 Hz panel and the relatively high asking price for an ARM-based laptop may give some buyers pause, they do little to detract from the overall experience. For users who prioritise performance, portability and all-day battery life, the ZenBook A14 makes a compelling case for itself and emerges as one of the more well-rounded ultraportables in its class.

● SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹1,65,990
Pros: Premium build, excellent battery life, lightweight design, great display, great performance
Cons: 60Hz display, premium pricing

QUICKLY.
Essar Energy Transition
secures \$400 m funding



New Delhi: Essar Energy Transition has successfully executed \$400 million in combined financing across two distinct facilities with three major banking institutions. The financing package includes the successful amendment and restatement of the company's receivables purchase agreement (RPA), expanding total commitments from \$150 million to \$350 million, EET said. OUR BUREAU

ONGC eyes Venezuela for
operation of oil blocks

New Delhi: Oil and Natural Gas Corp (ONGC) hopes to soon sign agreements with Venezuela to operate two oil blocks under the South American nation's new petroleum law, its finance chief said on Wednesday. ONGC, through its overseas investment arm ONGC Videsh, holds a 40 per cent stake in the San Cristobal field and, along with other Indian companies, an 18 per cent stake in the Carabobo-1 project. REUTERS

TRAI issues draft norms for enabling network slicing

TARIFF FLEXIBILITY. Move will allow telcos to charge different rates for 4G, 5G services

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Telecom regulator TRAI on Wednesday rolled out draft quality of service norms to accommodate mobile network slicing technology by telecommunication companies. The draft rules also propose to allow telecom operators to charge different rates for 4G, 5G and other services that they offer. The move by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) upholds network slicing technology recently rolled out by Bharti Airtel. However, other leading telcos Reliance Jio and Vodafone Idea did not support the technology, saying that they considered it to be discrimination against their subscribers. “Before launch of any new network slice, service provider must ensure that sufficient capacity is available in the network and shall submit the details, as per the format and manner prescribed by the Authority, before launch of such network slicing,” the



PRICING LEEWAY. The proposal by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India upholds network slicing technology recently rolled out by Bharti Airtel.

draft amendments to the Standards of Quality of Service of Access (Wireline and Wireless) and Broadband (Wireline and Wireless) Service Regulations, 2024, said. TRAI has proposed slicing of the network only when an operator has sufficient spectrum capacity. The draft proposes to change the “typical download and upload speed offered to the subscribers” sentence in the existing rule with “technology-wise typical download and upload

speed offered to the subscribers for each tariff offering”. The move will allow telecom operators to charge differently for different services like 4G and 5G. At present, users pay the same rate for 4G and 5G services. TRAI, however, has added a condition that the tariff offered for a particular service should have measurable download and upload speeds. The tariff will be non-compliant to the rules if 80

per cent of the tested download speed is lower than the advertised speed by the operator. According to the proposed rules, if the customers fail to get promised downloads, then service providers will need to notify the same to the affected customers and take corrective action, before submission of next compliance reports to the regulator.

SPECTRUM ALLOCATION The regulator has proposed the concept of allocation of a chunk of spectrum, or physical resource block (PRB), on 4G and 5G networks whose usage should not exceed 80 per cent during slicing. “Whenever PRB utilisation exceeds 80 per cent for any five days in a month, service providers must take necessary action to augment the capacity in a timely manner so that PRB utilisation reduces below 80 per cent,” the draft said. The regulator has fixed August 26 as the last date for submitting comments and September 7 for counter comments.

Tenure of Cabinet Secretary Somanathan, Home Secretary Mohan extended by a year

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government on Wednesday extended the tenure of Cabinet Secretary TV Somanathan and Home Secretary Govind Mohan for one year. “The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved extension in service of TV Somanathan, IAS (TN:87) as Cabinet Secretary for a further period of one year beyond August 30,” an order by the DoPT said. Somanathan was appointed as Cabinet Secretary with a tenure of two years from August 30, 2024. A Ph.D in Economics from Calcutta University, Somanathan holds the unique distinction of being a chartered accountant, company secretary and cost accountant. He joined the Finance Ministry as Expenditure Secretary in 2019 and was soon designated as the Finance Secretary in 2021, along with charge of the Expenditure department. He was scheduled to retire next year.



TV Somanathan



Govind Mohan

However, the Cabinet Secretary has a fixed tenure of two years; so his term will run through till 2026. He was previously Joint Secretary in the Corporate Affairs Ministry, before moving to the Prime Minister's Office as Joint Secretary/Additional Secretary to the Prime Minister from 2015 to 2017. Earlier, he worked in senior positions in the Tamil Nadu government, including as Deputy Secretary (Budget), Joint Vigilance Commissioner, Executive Director Metrowater, Secretary to the Chief Minister, and Additional Chief Secretary & Commissioner of Commercial Taxes. As Founder-MD of CMRL, he was responsible for achieving financial closure and awarding the initial tenders for implementing

the Chennai Metro Rail Project. **HOME SECRETARY** In a separate order, the DoPT said: “The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved extension in the service of Govind Mohan, IAS (SK:89) as Home Secretary, Ministry of Home Affairs for one year beyond August 22, 2026, that is, up to August 22, 2027, or until further orders, whichever is earlier, in relaxation of the provisions of FR 56 (d) and Rule 16 (1A) of the All India Services (Death-Cum-Retirement Benefits) Rules, 1958.” Mohan took over as Home Secretary after then incumbent Ajay Kumar Bhalla completed his extended tenure on August 22, 2024.

Services PMI slumps to 53.3 in July; hiring rebounds

Our Bureau
New Delhi

After manufacturing, the services sector too showed stress in July as the Purchasing Manager's Index dipped to 53.3 as against 57.4 in June, a report by S&P Global showed on Wednesday. Meanwhile, the good news is that hiring has rebounded. The services sector has maximum share, i.e., over 53 per cent in gross value added (GVA). On Monday, manufacturing PMI dropped to nearly 5 years low of 53.5. Manufacturing has a share of over 17 per cent in GVA. “India's services sector continued to expand in July, albeit at a slightly slower pace, as new business growth eased in both domestic and export markets after several months of strong performance,” said Pranjul Bhandari, Chief India Economist at HSBC. According to the report, business activity rose at the weakest rate in 53 months, as new business inflows increased only moder-



SILVER LINING. After sinking to a six-month low in June, there was an improvement in the rate of job creation during July

ately amid reports of softer demand, competitive pressures and fewer enquiries. New export business remained a bright spot, with firms citing gains from the UAE, the UK and the US. “Hiring showed a moderate rebound, while profit margins improved as input costs softened and firms increased their selling prices,” Bhandari said. The report said that after sinking to a six-month low in June, there was an improvement in the rate of job creation during July. The uptick was modest, however, as only 6 per cent of firms reported higher payroll

DGFT notifies export-only inventory rules for foreign funded e-comm firms

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) has notified procedures for foreign-funded e-commerce companies to undertake inventory-based operations, allowing them to hold stocks of Indian-made goods exclusively for exports. The notification, issued on Wednesday, puts into force the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade's (DPIIT) July 23 decision to relax FDI rules by allowing e-commerce firms with foreign investments to hold Indian-made goods for exports. While the relaxation is limited to exports, some experts cautioned that it could eventually lead to demands for allowing foreign-funded e-commerce firms to own inventory for domestic sales as well. “An e-commerce entity, other than a marketplace e-commerce entity, as defined under the consolidated FDI policy, may undertake export-only inventory operations through an exporter-on-record (EoR) registered under this framework. Such EoR may hold inventory of goods exclusively for export through e-commerce and



undertake all export-related activities, subject to this framework and the consolidated FDI Policy, as in force from time to time,” the DGFT notification highlighted. Indian manufacturers, primarily MSMEs, will continue to act as sellers-on-record (SoRs), supplying goods domestically and receiving payments in rupees, while the exporter-on-record (EoR) will procure the goods against confirmed export orders, own the inventory and handle exports.

BROADER WORRY “By leveraging a registered EoR, Indian sellers can access overseas markets while delegating export documentation, customs formalities, destination-country regulatory compliance, product testing and certification, packaging, labelling, fulfilment, logistics and reverse logistics to the EoR,”

per a DPIIT release. The new FDI relaxation raises a larger concern, trade policy think-tank GTRI said in a report. “Although currently limited to exports, it establishes the principle that foreign-funded e-commerce companies (read American) may own inventory. Soon, this could create pressure to extend the same model to domestic sales, opening the door to inventory-based e-commerce across all transactions,” it said. There are several safeguards within the framework to ensure that the benefits of e-commerce exports accrue to Indian manufacturers and MSMEs, the DPIIT release highlighted. “Export inventory may be procured only against confirmed export orders, and speculative inventory build-up for export purposes is not permitted. The export inventory must be distinctly identified, segregated and maintained through a digital repository to ensure complete traceability. Further, export inventory cannot be diverted for sale in the domestic market,” it stated. It also provides for timely payments to Indian sellers within the prescribed timeline, irrespective of the receipt of payment from overseas buyers.

SC grants States six weeks to respond to plea on disclosure of identity of shop owners

Aaratrika Bhaumik
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday granted six weeks to several States and Union Territories to respond to a public interest litigation (PIL) seeking directions requiring shop owners to display their identity, registration details and number of employees at their establishments to enable consumers to pursue complaints under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta was hearing a petition filed by lawyer and Bharatiya Janata Party leader Ashwini Kumar Upadhyay, seeking such disclosure requirements as a measure to safeguard consumer rights. During the hearing, Upadhyay informed the Bench that responses had so far been received from only a few States, including Haryana, Punjab, Bihar and Assam, as well as the Union Territory of Andaman and

Nicobar Islands. “We grant six weeks’ time to the respondents who have not filed responses to file the same,” the Bench said. The court posted the matter for further hearing after three months. The petition sought directions requiring shops to prominently display at their entrance details, including the name and address of the establishment, contact information, registration particulars and the number of employees, in a manner clearly visible to consumers. “Every consumer has a right to know about not only the quality, quantity, potency, purity standards, manufacturing and expiry date, Bureau of Indian Standards/Food Safety and Standards Authority of India certification, but also the details of distributors, dealers, sellers and shop owners, so as to seek redressal against unfair and restrictive trade practices and unscrupulous exploitation in the spirit of provisions of the 2019 Act,” the petition said.

Projects won via bidding before August 31, 2025 are exempt from ALMM for solar cells

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) has clarified that projects that were won through bidding on or before August 31, 2025, will be exempt from sourcing solar PV cells from ALMM-listed domestic manufacturers. The clarifications come after stakeholders reached out to the government on several directives related to the Approved List of Models and Manufacturers (ALMM) List-II for solar PV cells, which came into effect from June 1, 2026. “For projects awarded through bidding, if the last date of bid submission is on or before the cut-off date of August 31, 2025, the projects are exempt from ALMM List-II (for solar cells), else not. The applicability of this provision is to bids which were live as on July 28, 2025,” the MNRE said in an order. August 31 is the date falling one month after the publication of the initial ALMM List-II (July 31, 2025). However, if the bid conditions where the last date of submitting the bid was between December 9, 2024, and July 28, 2025, provided for usage of solar cells from the ALMM List-II, no exemption will be given, it clarified.



this list was modified by the Ministry. As the July 28, 2025, order modifies the 2024 order, which coupled with the issuance of the first ALMM list for solar cells on July 31, 2025, the ‘cut-off date’ for applicability of ALMM List-II on projects awarded through bidding has shifted from December 9, 2024, to August 31, 2025, the Ministry emphasised. Besides, the office order of July 2025 does not directly or automatically relax the bid conditions in tenders where the last date of submission was between December 9, 2024, and July 28, 2025, it further clarified. Similarly, the Ministry also clarified for Net Metering and Open Access projects. Projects that were commissioned by December 31, 2026, are exempt from the ALMM list for solar cells. Even though Net Metering and Open Access projects meeting the commissioning deadline are exempt from buying solar PV cells from ALMM-listed makers, they will have to source their modules only from ALMM listed manufacturers, it added.

SOLAR CELLS While December 9, 2024, is the date when the Ministry issued the directive for the ALMM list for solar cells was published, July 28, 2025, is when



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Extract of the Standalone and Consolidated unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter Ended 30.06.2026

Sl. No.	Particulars	STANDALONE				CONSOLIDATED			
		Quarter ended 30-06-2026 (UNAUDITED)	Quarter ended 31-03-2026 (AUDITED)	Quarter ended 30-06-2025 (UNAUDITED)	Year ended 31-03-2026 (AUDITED)	Quarter ended 30-06-2026 (UNAUDITED)	Quarter ended 31-03-2026 (AUDITED)	Quarter ended 30-06-2025 (UNAUDITED)	Year ended 31-03-2026 (AUDITED)
1	Total Income from Operations	19860.00	20,800.00	10,648.00	63,518.00	46891.00	43866.00	32785.00	154871.00
2	Net Profit before tax, non controlling interest & share in profit /(loss) of joint venture / associates (before exceptional items)	4755.00	4,964.00	1,757.00	12,871.00	9806.00	9542.00	4958.00	28315.00
3	Net Profit before tax , non controlling interest & share in profit/(loss)of joint venture/associates (after exceptional items)	5106.00	7,801.00	1,239.00	14,813.00	9806.00	12044.00	4958.00	29531.00
4	Net Profit after tax , non controlling interest & share in profit/(loss)of joint venture / associates (after exceptional items)	6492.00	7,096.00	1,871.00	13,298.00	10088.00	10778.00	4688.00	24333.00
5	Total Income (including other comprehensive income /(loss))	6492.00	7,095.00	1,871.00	13,287.00	10090.00	10756.00	4685.00	24719.00
6	Equity Share Capital	1956	1956	978	1956	1956	1,956	978	1,956
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet i.e. Other Equity	-	-	-	2,69,382.00	-	-	-	2,57,164.00
8	Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 1/- each) (for continuing operations) -(in Rs)	(Not annual-ised)	(Not annual-ised)	(Not annual-ised)	(Annualised)	(Not annualised)	(Not annual-ised)	(Not annual-ised)	(Not annual-ised)
1) Basic:		3.32	3.36	0.96	6.80	5.16	5.51	2.40	12.44
2) Diluted:		3.32	3.36	0.96	6.80	5.16	5.51	2.40	12.44

Notes:

1. The above is an extract of the detailed format of unaudited financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the unaudited financial results are available on the Investor section of our website www.vbshilpa.com and under corporate section of BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited.

2. The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Director at its meeting held on 5th August, 2026

Date: 5/8/2026
Place: Raichur



For and on behalf of the Board of Directors
Shilpa Medicare Limited
Sd/-
Omprakash Inani
Chairman

Sanguine note

Surprising optimism from RBI on growth and inflation

The Monetary Policy Committee’s decision to leave the policy repo rate and stance unchanged is unlikely to have surprised anyone. Events since the June meeting have weakened the case to embark on a new rate hiking cycle right away. Despite the continuing Iran standoff, global crude oil prices have cooled off from their peaks above \$100, although they continue to be volatile, as in July.



India has navigated the crisis caused by the closure of the Strait of Hormuz creditably — without rationing or panic-buying episodes. Graded fuel and gas price hikes have not triggered any disorderly spike in inflation readings. Consumer Price Index (CPI) inflation, which crept up from 3.48 per cent in April to 4.38 per cent in June, has remained within the RBI’s 2-6 per cent band. Nor are there any signs that higher energy costs are impacting prices outside the food and fuel complex. Core inflation in May-June has been quite tame at 2.3-2.4 per cent, excluding gold prices. On the monsoon front, after a deficit of 35 per cent in all-India rainfall in June, a normal July has narrowed the deficit to 13 per cent, leading to a catch-up in kharif acreage. Growth impulses remain strong, with industry and services indicators growing at a brisk pace in the last two months.

The rupee, often the unstated factor behind policy actions, has been better-behaved too. The Reserve Bank of India’s measures shielding banks from exchange risks have led to an FCNR (B) deposit influx of nearly \$40 billion so far. Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) flows, which led to a tight balance of payments situation at the end of the previous fiscal, have expanded by 15 per cent at the gross level and over 60 per cent at the net level in April-June 2026. So far this fiscal, foreign portfolio inflows in debt have more than made up for outflows on equities. These factors seem to have prompted the RBI to revise its FY27 GDP growth projections upwards to 6.7 per cent, from 6.6 per cent in June. The inflation forecast has been trimmed to 5 per cent from 5.1 per cent, with the Q2 estimate sharply cut from 5.1 per cent to 4.7 per cent.

Yet, the future is not without uncertainty. In that context, Governor Sanjay Malhotra’s statement struck a rather sanguine note on growth and inflation prospects. With the Iran situation in a limbo, upside risks to inflation remain. Foreign portfolio flows should be seen as a fickle source of dollar inflows. A mere hint by the Federal Reserve that it is relooking at rate hikes, a spike in US treasury yields or global risk-off sentiment due to ongoing AI unwind trade, could dent portfolio inflows that have been shoring up the rupee. With El Nino still in the air and kharif sowing only halfway through, there’s scope for surprise spirals in food prices, too. One hopes that RBI’s optimism is no more than skin-deep — aimed at shoring up sentiment. Its vigil must remain keen as ever, as far as the economy and financial stability are concerned.

POCKET RAVIKANTH



GANGA NARAYAN RATH

The Finance Ministry recently tabled a bill proposing to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007 empowering the government to levy MDR (Merchant Discount Rate) on “one or more electronic modes” of payment, including UPI.”

The debate over subjecting UPI transactions to a service charge — MDR — was initiated in August 2022 by the RBI itself through a “Discussion Paper on Changes in Payment System.” To promote UPI at that time, the Finance Ministry rightfully set aside the RBI paper, while continued advocacy kept the MDR debate alive. Since then, the stakeholders have kept the opinion poll in a permanent campaign mode, with news of sporadic wins and losses popping up now and then depending upon whether there is red or black ink on their balance sheets.

The debate took a favourable turn with the payment industry successfully convincing the Parliamentary Standing Committee early this year that the current zero-MDR regime puts pressure on government finances and limits the ecosystem’s ability to invest in long-term infrastructure. On the back of the Standing Committee’s report comes the proposed bill to give flexibility to the government to decide which digital payment modes should remain exempt from charges and which could attract MDR.

This has rekindled the interest of third-party application providers and payment processors who have long sought a sustainable revenue model.

UPI SCALING WITH SUPPORT
As of early 2026, UPI’s scale has reached considerable heights, with monthly volumes exceeding 21.7 billion transactions and value crossing ₹28.33 lakh crore. While the volumes endorse ease of making small payments, they also place a substantial financial burden on banks and payment service providers managing the servers, security systems, and fraud prevention infrastructure that keep the network running.

The government has been making budgetary allocations to incentivise digital payments since FY2021-22. Those allocations have followed an uneven path: ₹2,485 crore in FY24, falling to ₹1,146 crore in FY25, with ₹2,200 crore budgeted for FY26 and estimated ₹2,000 crore for FY27. The Department of Financial Services confirmed to the Parliamentary Committee that these incentives cover only around 11 per cent of actual industry costs and represent approximately 14 per cent of the MDR revenue the industry forgoes under the current policy. Industry estimates place

Service charge on UPI transactions makes sense

The current zero-MDR regime puts pressure on govt finances and limits the ecosystem’s ability to invest in long-term infrastructure



actual operational costs closer to ₹20,000 crore annually, leaving a funding gap that the incentive scheme, in its present trajectory, cannot close.

NECESSARY TO KEEP IN STEP
On the technical side, the MDR landscape is already moving towards a tiered model. While basic UPI remains free, RuPay Credit Card on UPI and PPI wallet transactions now carry an MDR of up to 2 per cent for transactions

The case for exempting small-value transactions from MDR is well-founded. The question is, whether the same logic extends to large value transactions processed by organised commercial users

exceeding ₹2,000. This targeted approach protects small *kirana* stores and low-ticket daily purchases, which account for over 80 per cent of total transaction volume, while asking larger merchants to contribute to the system’s upkeep.

Proponents of the status quo argue that any friction, even a 0.1 per cent fee, could drive small vendors back to cash, reversing years of progress in formalising the economy. Proponents of a fee structure counter that a digital public infrastructure of UPI’s scale requires a durable revenue model to fund future development — including 5G integration and cross border expansion — rather than indefinite reliance on taxpayer-funded subsidies.

DIRECTION IS CLEAR
The RBI Discussion Paper engaged directly with this tension: whether a payment service should recover costs from its users, or whether the presence

of a public good element justifies absorbing those costs as a state obligation. The paper acknowledged that “the government and regulators have an important role in ensuring wider acceptance of payment systems.” It also recognised that full cost absorption by the state is not the only available model. In practice, governments routinely build infrastructure in partnership with the private sector and permit partial cost recovery from users. Roads built under the highway authority model are one example.

The toll structure is the mechanism through which commercial users contribute to the cost of infrastructure they could not have efficiently built alone. The more relevant domestic parallel, however, sits within the payments system itself.

NEFT and RTGS transactions recover charges from users, structured in bands of transaction value. Those charges have not suppressed adoption. Electronic fund transfer volumes have grown consistently because the opportunity cost of moving money efficiently is higher than the cost of the transfer. The same logic applies to high-value UPI transactions processed by large commercial entities. For a retail chain settling thousands of transactions daily, a nominal MDR is not friction. It is a cost of operating on infrastructure that makes that settlement possible.

A large share of UPI’s user base remains in segments where any marginal cost could affect adoption. With India’s financial inclusion index at 67 per cent, the case for exempting small-value transactions from MDR is well-founded. That exemption is not disputed. The question is, whether the same zero-cost logic extend even to large value transactions processed by organised commercial users who derive direct revenue from the network’s reliability and reach. It should not.

The appropriate design mirrors what the payments system already does for NEFT and RTGS: band the MDR by transaction value, exempt low-value transactions entirely, and apply a nominal charge to high-value commercial processing. The Parliamentary Committee has pointed in this direction. The RBI’s own 2022 Discussion Paper pointed in this direction. The data on the funding gap confirms the direction.

“...establishing a viable revenue mechanism is critical to ensuring the UPI ecosystem achieves financial sustainability without perpetually straining the government exchequer,” stated the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Finance, Report on Demands for Grants, Department of Financial Services. With the proposed Bill, the government intent is clear. Hopefully, the amendment gets enacted quickly translating it into implementation.

The writer is former chief general manager, Reserve Bank of India. Views are personal

MPC’s latest forecasts reflect positive sentiment

It has raised GDP growth and pared CPI inflation projections. This reduces the likelihood of rate tightening in October policy

Aditi Nayar

The Monetary Policy Committee’s (MPC’s) decision to maintain status quo in the August meeting was a foregone conclusion. Limited evidence of generalisation of inflationary pressures, favourable impact of the measures to attract capital flows announced in June amid continued uncertainty around geopolitical tensions and monsoon outcomes reduced the urgency to hike rates. Overall, the tone of the policy document was relatively more benign, in contrast with the hawkish commentary in June.

Amidst the global uncertainty that has prevailed since March 2026, the MPC’s latest forecasts exude a degree of confidence. The MPC expects GDP growth to be 6.7 per cent in FY27, 10 basis points (bps) higher than its previous forecast, with an upward revision in the forecasts for H1 FY27. High frequency indicators for the last few months continue to belie the uncertainty generated by the West Asia conflict, and the monsoon, which have taken a toll on both rural and urban consumer confidence. However, Q1 corporate results do reveal that margins have borne the brunt of commodity

price inflation and supply chain disruptions. Simultaneously, the Committee has pared the CPI inflation projection for the fiscal by 10 bps to 5 per cent, led by a lower-than-expected print for Q1 and a cut in the forecast for Q2 FY27. We broadly concur with the Committee’s growth and inflation forecasts and believe that these are appropriate for an average crude oil price of \$80-85/barrel and a mild YoY fall in kharif sowing.

EVENLY BALANCED
Besides, the MPC’s assessment of risks around the growth and inflation forecasts for FY27 shifted to ‘evenly balanced’ from adverse in the June meeting, reducing the likelihood for an impending rate tightening in the upcoming October policy review. However, adverse geopolitical developments resulting in a sharp rise in crude oil and commodity prices, and unfavourable domestic monsoon outcomes remain a cause for concern. Thereafter, we believe that the December meeting would be live for policy action.

While inflation has only just crossed the 4 per cent mark, i.e., the mid-point of the Committee’s medium term target range of 2-6 per cent, and trimmed core inflation remains surprisingly benign, an



MPC. Benign policy tone GETTY IMAGES

adverse base means that inflation prints are certainly set to harden appreciably in the next few months. In line with this, the MPC’s CPI inflation projections from Q3 FY27 through Q1 FY28 remain anchored between 5 per cent and 6 per cent.

This suggests that the real policy rate would be inverted during that period, if kept unchanged, supporting the case for a rate hike in December or later. Further any confirmation around generalisation of inflationary pressures beyond the food and fuel basket in the near term, notwithstanding the adverse base effect in Q3 FY27, would strengthen the case for a rate hike.

In contrast, a favourable rainfall in the

remaining part of the Southwest Monsoon season, along with sustainable dip in crude oil prices to \$70-75/barrel, could lead to a delay in the onset of the rate hike cycle, even if these do not lead to material revisions in the near-term CPI inflation projections. This would augment the case for looking through a transient supply-led inflation spike, if inflation projections beyond Q1 FY28 dip below 5 per cent.

Mirroring the geopolitical volatility, as well as tempestuous FPI flows, bond yields have fluctuated over the last six months. After rising to 7.13 per cent on May 18, 2026, India’s 10-year G-Sec yield cooled to 6.70 per cent in early-July, following softening in crude oil prices, favourable measures introduced by the RBI to attract capital flows, and the removal of capital gains and withholding taxes on G-Sec investments by FPIs. Thereafter, it has hovered around the 6.80 per cent mark, amid intermittent renewal of tensions in West Asia and consequent inflationary and fiscal risks. Yields were largely unchanged after the August 2026 status quo policy outcome. We expect the 10-year G-Sec yield to trade at 6.70-6.90 per cent in the near term, until a rate hike appears imminent.

The writer is Chief Economist, Head-Research & Outreach, ICRA

LETTERS TO EDITOR Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Heat stress
Apropos, 'Rising temperature hurts labour productivity' (August 5). Escalating temperatures constitute a profound challenge to both economic productivity and educational advancement. Prolonged heat exposure undermines labour efficiency by diminishing physical stamina, cognitive precision and decision-making capacity, thereby suppressing industrial output and escalating occupational risks. Simultaneously, excessive classroom heat and disrupted sleep impair

students' concentration, memory consolidation and analytical aptitude, compromising academic achievement. Governments must institutionalise heat-resilient infrastructure, climate-responsive urban planning, and robust occupational safeguards to preserve human capital and ensure sustainable socioeconomic progress.
N Sadhasiva Reddy
Bengaluru

Digital arrests
Apropos 'SC mandates SOPs to curb

digital arrests, ensure refunds' (August 5), the Supreme Court's direction to the RBI to frame an SOP is timely, as digital arrest scams continue to target vulnerable citizens. The RBI must crack down on mule and cyber fraud-linked accounts to curb the growing menace of digital fraud.
PV Prakash
Mumbai

LIC's investment
The news 'LIC's investment portfolio shifts decisively away from loans' (August 5), is a matter of

significance. Change is necessary for growth. But the total skipping of loans and the evident embracing of private unlisted equity is cause for concern. Reasonable growth with adequate liquidity, utmost safety and security of hard earned money are what people rely on for, in insurance. Unbridled courting of private/unlisted equity is no prescription for any of the above.
Jose Abraham
Valkom, Kottayam

Soil health
When farmers choose crops solely

to maximise monetary returns, excessive use of chemical fertilizers becomes inevitable, with little attention paid to restoring soil humus, resulting in progressive soil degradation. Agricultural universities and Krishi Vigyan Kendras must be entrusted with promoting scientifically guided crop diversification under the supervision of planning bodies to ensure balanced crop production and prevent both overproduction and market gluts.
Rajiv Magal
Halekere Village, Karnataka



QUICKLY.

Oyster Renewable adds 52.8 MW wind project

Ahmedabad: Oyster Renewable Energy Pvt Ltd has commissioned 52.8 MW of wind capacity in Dayapar, Gujarat, marking its entry into the State and advancing the second phase of its 99 MW Gujarat wind project being developed for Jindal Stainless Ltd (JSL). The commissioned facility comprises 16 turbines and involved an investment of around ₹385 crore. It is part of Oyster Renewable's larger 315.6 MW solar-wind hybrid project for JSL, which includes 216 MW of solar capacity in Madhya Pradesh and 99 MW of wind capacity in Gujarat. The overall project entails an investment of over ₹2,000 crore. OUR BUREAU

IBM opens FutureNow Centre in Visakhapatnam

Hyderabad: IBM has on Wednesday opened its new IBM Consulting FutureNow Centre in Visakhapatnam. The FutureNow Centre reflects IBM's focus on expanding innovation and delivery capabilities in emerging technology hubs across India. OUR BUREAU

Govt explores special Parliament session to revive women’s quota, delimitation Bills

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Union government has begun consultations with the Opposition on convening a special session of Parliament later this month to revive two key constitutional amendment Bills on women's reservation and delimitation that failed to clear Parliament earlier this year due to a lack of the required special majority.

Proposed UPI MDR may shift focus of fintechs from consumers to merchants

SELECTIVE RATE. The merchant discount rate on UPI may apply only to high-value merchant transactions

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

The proposed reintroduction of merchant discount rate (MDR) on select unified payments interface (UPI) transactions is being welcomed by fintech companies, which see it as a long-awaited step towards making India's digital payments ecosystem financially sustainable.

According to people familiar with the discussions, the MDR on UPI is likely to be in the range of 25-30 basis points and may apply only to high-value merchant transactions, likely above ₹2,000 and large commercial entities. The thresholds and exemptions, however, are still being finalised, with the government expected to take the final call.

Industry executives said the move, if implemented, could fundamentally reshape competition in the payments ecosystem by shifting the focus from consumer acquisition to mer-



SERVICE PIVOT. Industry executives said that the move, if implemented, could fundamentally reshape competition in the payments ecosystem

chant servicing. “Till now, fintechs were largely focused on the consumer side of UPI, but with this, the focus shifts to merchants and the kind of merchant base one has,” said the founder of a fintech start-up, adding that companies with deeper merchant networks stand to benefit the most.

The proposal gathered momentum after RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra stated, following the Monet-

ary Policy Committee meeting, that India needs to continue investing in its digital payments infrastructure, whether through MDR or other mechanisms. While the RBI is expected to frame the operational rules, industry executives said the decision to levy MDR is ultimately a policy matter for the Centre.

DIGITAL TRANSACTIONS
MDR is the commission paid

by merchants to banks and payment service providers for processing digital transactions. Consumers are not charged.

While debit and credit card payments already attract MDR — typically around 80-90 basis points for debit cards and up to 250 basis points for credit cards — UPI merchant transactions have remained MDR-free since January 2020.

On August 3, the government introduced a Bill in Parliament to amend provisions of the law that had effectively barred banks and payment firms from charging MDR on specified digital transactions, reviving hopes that the fee could return in a limited form.

GOVT INCENTIVES
“The ecosystem spends anywhere around ₹10,000-12,000 crore every year to power UPI transactions. Of this, the government gives only about ₹2,000 crore by way of incentives. The rest gets absorbed by the ecosys-

tem,” said a fintech executive.

Shauryam Gupta, Chief Executive Officer of Rupeezy, said that a capped MDR on high-value business transactions would help bridge the structural funding gap without affecting small merchants, who account for the bulk of UPI volumes.

Brokerage Jefferies estimates that a 15-30 basis point MDR on merchant payments above ₹2,000 could generate ₹5,000-10,000 crore in annual revenue for payment companies.

Although such transactions accounted for only about 4 per cent of UPI volumes in FY26, they represented nearly 67 per cent of the total transaction value.

Preliminary industry estimates suggest a 25 basis point levy could generate around ₹13,000 crore annually, providing payment firms with a meaningful revenue stream to invest in infrastructure, security and innovation.

No ethics or values challenge at HDFC Bank, says Chairman Kumar

Press Trust of India
Mumbai



Rajiv Kumar, Non-Executive Chairman, HDFC Bank

HDFC Bank's Non-Executive Chairman Rajiv Kumar on Wednesday affirmed that there are no “ethics or values” based challenges at the country's largest private sector lender and vowed to preserve shareholders' trust with the highest standards of governance.

Kumar, a career bureaucrat who took over the assignment amid a tumultuous time for the bank after the sudden exit of Atanu Chakraborty from the seat, acknowledged that there is a lot of “dust” in the air and sought to clear what he called as the doubts on the horizon. “Systematically, there is nothing which has the challenge on either ethical or value parameters. Things are fine, the balance sheet is very pristine,” he told shareholders while officiating at the lender's 32nd annual general meeting held virtually.

It can be recalled that Chakraborty had resigned in March this year citing concerns on ethics and values, leading to questions among all stakeholders. After a short stint by Keki Mistry in the interim, Kumar, who has also served as the Chief Election Commissioner, was appointed as the Non-Executive Chairman of the lender, amid questions about ethics.

holder concerns on value creation and specifically the bank's merger with mortgage major parent HDFC dragging down performance, Kumar promised to lift the share of the low-cost current and saving account deposits and consequently the net interest margins as well over the next few quarters.

CASA RATIO
Jagdishan said that the CASA ratio, which has been on a declining trend, will start moving upwards from mid-2027 onward courtesy the investments done by the bank, including adding 4,000 branches over the last five years, while Kumar said that the work culture gives him the confidence to attain the aspiration.

The MD also said that the investments made in technology over the last few years will start reaping dividends by way of multiple account openings and larger balances from the same customer.

“We will have more low cost fund ratio. Mid-2027 onwards, we will start to move upwards, which will have a favourable impact on NIMs,” Jagdishan said, stressing that the merger is important for the bank from a long-term perspective and the bank has to undergo the period of adjustments that it is undergoing right now.

WRONG PRACTICES
The bank board has found certain wrong practices being followed to tap high-value deposits from MSRDC and also fined the management led by Managing Director and Chief Executive Sashidharan Jagdishan while clearing them of any *mala fide* intent.

‘Right policy can drive explosive category growth’

bl.interview

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

United Breweries Ltd (UBL) reported a mixed set of Q1FY27 results. Revenue from operations rose 10 per cent year-on-year to ₹5,919.44 crore from ₹5,380.78 crore, while net sales increased 7 per cent to ₹3,065 crore.

However, profit after tax declined 9 per cent to ₹166 crore from ₹184 crore in the year-ago quarter and EBIT margin contracted 96 basis points to 8.1 per cent.

Following the results, UBL shares were trading at ₹1,400, down 2.32 per cent on Wednesday.

In an interaction, Vivek Gupta, Managing Director and CEO of United Breweries, spoke about pricing actions due to West Asia conflict, the impact of state policy reforms, capacity expansion plans and category growth.

Edited excerpts:

Any key developments during the quarter?
We are excited about the continued momentum in



Last quarter, we had mentioned a significant impact of ₹400-500 cr due to the West Asia conflict

VIVEK GUPTA
MD and CEO of United Breweries



category growth. This is the second quarter in a row where the category grew double-digit. For UBL, our sell-through volumes were up 13 per cent, and our sell-in volumes were up 9 per cent.

The second highlight is that the premiumisation strategy continues to work. Other than the two states where we make conscious calls, our premium business again grew 17 per cent in one of the most important quarters for the category.

Last quarter, we had mentioned a significant impact of ₹400-500 crore due to the West Asia conflict. In reality, bottle and cartel prices went up; the Indian rupee went to 95. All this impacted 300 bps of gross margins, and we took significant actions in pricing, mix, and cost initiat-

ives to mitigate half of the impact. So, we have taken pricing actions in almost 22 states and need to take actions in the core states of Telangana, Andhra and Tamil Nadu. We have been in touch with the governments and have given representation as the right pricing is extremely important. We continue to become disciplined on our cash and cost. This quarter, we reduced our inventories by 20 per cent. However, our free operating cash flow increased by 38 per cent.

Has the recent policy change in Karnataka started translating into any business tailwinds?
This is the third month of the policy change and we are seeing a positive category momentum. This is not only in

Karnataka, but even behind the privatisation of retail in Jharkhand. We continue to see category growth in Maharashtra as well. These stories show that when the policy intervention is right, there could be explosive growth in the category and revenue for the states.

With premium volumes now contributing meaningfully to margins, how do you see the premium-to-mass mix evolving? Do you expect premium to overtake the mass segment?

I don't see the premium overtaking the mass segment, despite the category growth rate being ahead of mass. India is a diverse country. We need to ensure that beer is affordable in the economy and mainstream categories. If we expect the whole category to grow in high single-digit to double-digit, the premium category will grow at more than 20 per cent.

Economy and mainstream would grow at low single digits. That mix will continue.

However, premium is only 20 per cent of the category and we don't see that materi-

ally changing.

Are there any greenfield or brownfield projects planned?

We announced the construction of a new brewery in Uttar Pradesh, which will be ready by next year. Last week, we produced our first can in Telangana. The new can line, which is a brownfield project in Maharashtra, will be completed by the end of this quarter. We are also working on a new brewery in West Bengal by early next year, which will have local can production as well.

How much of the quarter's growth was driven by volume versus pricing? What is your outlook for the rest of FY27?

Most of the growth is volume-driven. Sell-through is 13 per cent and net sales are lower because most of the pricing actions are not yet in the market. It came on the front end of the quarter. So it's mostly volume-led growth versus pricing-led growth. The category momentum will continue in the coming quarters because some of it is behind structural reforms.

‘AI can help companies personalise products at scale’

Our Bureau
Chennai

AI has the ability to fundamentally reshape business by helping them deliver personalised products and services to every customer at scale, according to MS Krishnan, Accenture Professor of Computer Information Systems and Professor of Technology and Operations at the Ross Business School, University of Michigan.

Krishnan was addressing the second edition of the ‘CK Prahalad Next Practice Oration’, organised by TVS Capital, here on Thursday.

The oration was in the memory of CK Prahalad, an internationally renowned management consultant, professor and the author of several best-selling management and corporate strategy books.

Krishnan was expanding on CK Prahalad's ‘N=1, R=G’ framework, which suggests that companies can leverage digital tools and global talent to customise products for every customer. He suggested that AI can amplify this personalisation and transform entire organisations, both in terms of customer interactions to internal decision-making.

“AI can help firms combine the efficiency of mass production with the personalisation traditionally associ-



Gopal Srinivasan (left), CMD, TVS Capital Funds, with MS Krishnan, Accenture Professor of Information Systems and Professor of Technology & Operations at Ross Business School, University of Michigan, at the 2nd CK Prahalad Next Practice Oration in Chennai on Wednesday. BUJOY GHOSH

ated with handcrafted products, with applications ranging from healthcare to retail and manufacturing,” he added.

AWARD RECEIVERS

During the event, S4S technologies was awarded the CK Prahalad Next Practice Award. S4S technologies is an agri-tech firm that helps reduce food loss by buying cosmetically damaged surplus produce from small-holder farmers, processing it using solar dryers and supplying shelf-stable ingredients to food businesses.

Audio entertainment start-up Pocket FM received an honourable mention. Other start-ups shortlisted for the award included Exponent Energy and Dhruva

Aerospace from about 1,500 applications.

In his inaugural address, Gopal Srinivasan, Chairman and Managing Director, TVS Capital Funds, said CK Prahalad's future-focused thinking and emphasis on ‘next practices’ instead of ‘best practices’ are essential guiding principles for entrepreneurs and business leaders.

News outlets can report courts, but can’t utilise AV clips of proceedings: SC

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi



The Supreme Court has clarified on July 31 that recognised news outlets can continue to report on court proceedings, but without “utilising” audio and video clippings of judicial hearings.

This would mean that recognised news outlets cannot post raw or edited audio and video content on social media or digital platforms, ostensibly for commercial purposes.

A Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant passed the July 31 order to clear the “confusion” over an earlier judicial direction on

gital platforms without prior permission of the Secretary General of the Supreme Court or the Registrars General of the jurisdictional High Courts.

“The paragraph [in the July 24 order] makes it clear that the order is not to be construed as imposing a blanket prohibition on the reporting of court proceedings by recognised news outlets.

“Such outlets may, therefore, continue to report on the proceedings and inform the general public of legal developments and judicial pronouncements, save that audio or video clips of the court proceedings shall not be utilised in the course of such re-

portage,” the court order on July 31 clarified. On July 31, the apex court had flagged its intent to lay down a protocol by which online users who want to post or circulate livestreamed judicial proceedings in the apex court and State High Courts could only access the audio-visual content through the courts' archives.

CJ's RESPONSE

Chief Justice Kant had said livestreamed visuals of court proceedings cannot be subject to “misuse” or “commercial exploitation” while responding to an application filed by two activists, Anjali Bhardwaj and Amrita Johri, seeking a modification of a

July 24 interim order barring the circulation of livestreamed proceedings on social media and digital platforms.

The applicants, represented by advocates Prashant Bhushan and Cheryl D'Souza, had criticised the July 24 order as a reversal of the ‘principle of open justice’ upheld by the apex court itself in a plethora of judgments.

Objecting to a complete ban on dissemination of court proceedings on digital platforms, the activists had said that open access to justice ensured that the judicial process remained answerable to the public and guards against arbitrariness.

THE ANDHRA PETROCHEMICALS LIMITED
Regd. Office: Venkatarayapuram, TANUKU - 534 215
CIN:L23209AP1984PLC004635 : Website:www.theandhrapetrochemicals.com
Tel: 08819-224075,224755 Fax: 08819-224168 E-mail: info.tnk@theandhrapetrochemicals.com

Statement of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30.06.2026

The detailed format of financial results for the quarter ended 30.06.2026 were filed with the Bombay Stock Exchange under Regulation 33 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 and the same are available on the Company's website www.theandhrapetrochemicals.com. The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below:

P. NARENDRANATH CHOWDARY
Managing Director
DIN: 00015764

Place: Tanuku
Date: 05th August, 2026

QUICKLY.

Gold gains sheen on weaker dollar



Gold jumped over three per cent on Wednesday, propelled by a weaker US dollar and lower Treasury yields, while markets monitored developments in West Asia. Spot gold climbed three per cent to \$4,199.78 per ounce by 1344 GMT. US gold futures rose 2.6 per cent to \$4,260.80. Silver was up 4.2 per cent to \$62.05. REUTERS

Tight stocks outside US lift copper

London: Copper prices held above the psychological level of \$14,000 a tonne, supported by falling inventories in the LME system as more metal was pulled into the US ahead of potential tariffs on refined copper. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME was down 0.1 per cent at \$14,053 a tonne. Zinc rose 0.5 per cent to \$3,691. REUTERS

Crude oil steadies on hopes of peace deal



Crude oil steadied amid mounting signs that the US and Iran are nearing a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz. Brent traded around \$80 a barrel, following a 12 per cent slump in the prior two sessions. WTI inched lower to trade around \$75, following an 11 per cent slump in the prior two sessions. BLOOMBERG

In June, central banks made the highest gold purchase for this year

WGC REPORT. They continued to buy for 3rd month in a row, accumulating a net of 51 tonnes, led by Poland and China

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Central banks across the world continued buying gold for the third consecutive month in June, data from the World Gold Council (WGC) showed. It was the highest purchase by them this year. “Central banks bought 51 tonnes of gold in June, with Poland and China continuing to lead gold accumulation. Buyers for the month included Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, Jordan, the Czech Republic, Ghana and Georgia. Net sellers were Russia and Türkiye,” said Marissa Salim, Senior Research Lead, APAC, WGC.

In the first half of this year, central banks reported buying 102 tonnes, with purchases spread across a broad cohort of emerging market

central banks. In March, they sold a net 30 tonnes of gold. Since then, they have been net buyers, purchasing 17 tonnes in April and 41 tonnes in May.

POLAND TOP BUYER
Salim said the National Bank of Poland was the largest buyer in June, adding 19 tonnes more to its reserves. The People’s Bank of China followed with a purchase of 15 tonnes. With this, the Chinese bank has been buying for 20 consecutive months. Other central banks to procure gold in June were Uzbekistan (9 tonnes) and Kazakhstan (7 tonnes). Both continued their buying spree.

Jordan bought (3 tonnes), while Georgia (1 tonne) and Ghana (1 tonne) re-entered the market in June. Others to procure the yellow metal

How central banks have traded in gold in June

Gross purchase	61 tonnes
Gross sales	12 tonnes
Net buying Jan-June	102 tonnes
Monthly average buying	27 tonnes

Source: World Gold Council

were the Czech Republic (2 tonnes) and Türkiye (2 tonnes). Though Türkiye purchased 2 tonnes, it also sold a similar quantity. Russia continued to be the biggest seller of gold, off-loading 9 tonnes.

TURKIYE NO 1 SELLER
At the end of the first half, Poland remained the top buyer, accumulating 82 tonnes, followed by Uzbekistan, which has purchased 41 tonnes.

China and Kazakhstan have been the other major

ICAR cracks India’s 1st complete pigeonpea genome

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) on Tuesday announced the development of India’s first fully annotated telomere-to-telomere (‘T2T’) reference genome for pigeonpea (*Ca-janus cajan* L. Millsp.) variety ‘Asha’, marking a major milestone in pulse genomics.

The T2T genome comprises 752.65 million base pairs assembled into 92 contigs, providing a complete representation of all 11 pigeonpea chromosomes.

The assembly, designated NIPB_CctT2T_4, has been deposited in the global NCBI

database, the ICAR said.

The chromosome-level assembly includes complete centromeres and telomeres. Genome annotation identified 36,557 genes and 48,008 mRNA transcripts, while transcriptome (RNA sequencing) mapping achieved over 99.9 per cent read alignment, underscoring the genome’s accuracy and completeness.

Popularly known as arhar or tur, pigeonpea is one of India’s key pulse crops and an important source of dietary protein.

The ICAR–National Institute for Plant Biotechnology (NIPB), New Delhi, had published the world’s first draft genome of the ‘Asha’ variety



in 2011 — the first crop genome to be sequenced entirely in India. An improved draft followed in 2017.

CLIMATE-RESILIENT BREEDING
According to ICAR, the fully annotated T2T genome will serve as a national genomic resource for advanced gene and pangenome analyses,

The breakthrough genome resource is expected to speed up gene discovery, precision breeding and productivity gains

identification of genes linked to agronomic and nutritional traits, and the application of molecular breeding and genome-editing tools.

The breakthrough is expected to accelerate the development of high-yielding, climate-resilient and nutritionally improved pigeonpea varieties, strengthening In-

dia’s pulse improvement programme and contributing to higher productivity, better farmer incomes and food and nutritional security.

SELF-SUFFICIENCY
The development comes as the Centre rolls out the Mission for Aatmanirbharta in Pulses (2025-26 to 2030-31) to achieve self-sufficiency in pulse production.

Last month, Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan urged scientists to find non-GMO solutions to improve pulse productivity, asking why India could not match the yields achieved by countries without access to GM seeds.

Rice purchase up 5% this season as govt buys 18% more from rabi crop

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

India has achieved 99 per cent of its rice procurement target of 575.52 lakh tonnes (lt) for the 2025-26 marketing season (October–September), with purchases running 5 per cent higher than a year ago. With the next marketing season beginning on October 1, the Centre may need to accelerate the disposal of surplus stocks ahead of procurement for the 2026-27 season.

The marginal 2 per cent decline in kharif paddy acreage so far has raised hopes of another bumper harvest, provided the monsoon remains favourable through August and September.

The government had set a procurement target of 485.95 lt of rice from the kharif crop and 89.57 lt from

Rice procurement during October 1-August 4, 2025 (lakh tonnes)

	2024-25	2025-26	% Change
Punjab	116.13	104.86	-9.7
Haryana	35.99	41.58	15.5
Tamil Nadu	30.86	29.20	-5.4
Uttar Pradesh	38.66	41.75	8.0
Chhattisgarh	78.00	73.00	-6.4
Uttarakhand	4.51	5.02	11.3
Telangana	67.29	82.18	22.1
Andhra Pradesh	25.60	39.59	54.6
West Bengal	19.91	16.71	-16.1
Odisha	50.12	54.2	8.1
Bihar	26.28	25.02	-4.8
Madhya Pradesh	29.16	34.67	18.9
Maharashtra	10.16	12.50	23.0
Others	6.46	6.92	7.1
All India	542.85	571.14	5.2

Source: Central Food Grains Procurement Portal

the rabi crop this season. Total procurement in 2024-25 stood at \$45.22 lt.

PROCUREMENT UP 5%
According to official data, rice procurement had reached 571.14 lt as of August 4, compared with 542.85

lt in the corresponding period last year.

Procurement of the kharif crop has concluded across all States, while purchases from the rabi crop will continue until September 30.

For the rabi season (April–September), the Centre had

targeted procurement of 43 lt from Telangana, 14 lt from Tamil Nadu, 11 lt from Odisha and 10 lt from Andhra Pradesh.

The actual rabi procurement has touched 86.71 lt, up 18 per cent from 73.45 lt a year ago.

TELANGANA LEADS
Telangana accounted for the largest share of rabi procurement at 42.69 lt, followed by Tamil Nadu (13.20 lt), Andhra Pradesh (11.83 lt) and Odisha (11.04 lt).

The rice marketing season begins in October, though procurement schedules vary across the States depending on cropping patterns.

With paddy arriving earlier than usual this year, the Centre has advanced procurement in Punjab and Haryana to mid-September and in Tamil Nadu to September 1.

Urad eases on better crop prospects, weak demand

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Prices of urad (black gram) have begun easing after rallying a few weeks ago, amid expectations of a better kharif crop following higher acreage across Central and Northern India and subdued demand from millers. Acreage was up 10 per cent at 21.08 lakh hectares (lh) as of July 31, compared with 19.18 lh a year ago, even as the overall pulses area remained below last year’s level.

Sowing has risen sharply in key producing States. Uttar Pradesh reported a 61 per cent jump in acreage to 5.52 lh (3.42 lh a year ago), while Madhya Pradesh recorded a 16 per cent increase to 6.72 lh (5.79 lh). Acreage also rose 20 per cent in Rajasthan to 3.75 lh (3.11 lh), 40 per cent in Gujarat to 0.71 lh (0.50 lh), 72 per cent in Jharkhand to 0.44 lh (0.26 lh), 21 per cent in Chhattisgarh to 0.58 lh (0.48 lh) and 43 per cent in



OFF THE BOIL. The all-India average wholesale *mandi* prices of urad have eased to ₹8,638 per quintal as of August 3

Andhra Pradesh to 0.16 lh (0.11 lh).

However, sowing declined in Karnataka by 25 per cent to 0.71 lh (0.95 lh) and in Maharashtra by 50 per cent to 1.76 lh (3.58 lh).

Per Agriculture Ministry data, the all-India average wholesale *mandi* price of urad eased to ₹8,638 per quintal as of August 3, down from ₹8,908 a week earlier and ₹8,980 two weeks ago.

Around three weeks ago, prices had climbed to a recent high of ₹9,133 per quintal, up from about

Tax holiday for roughs to boost diamond exports by \$3-5 billion

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai



The proposed 15-year income tax exemption for rough diamond sale in India under the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, has the potential to make India a large rough diamond trading hub as the country already leads in cut and polish trade.

The Bill proposes income tax exemption till March 31, 2041, for eligible foreign mining and trading entities including sightholders, brokers, aggregators and tender and auction entities on the sale of rough diamonds conducted through notified Special Notified Zones (SNZs) like those in Mumbai and Surat.

Currently, foreign entities are allowed only to showcase their rough diamonds at SNZs.

Domestic cut and polished diamond companies have to buy in the miners’ online auction conducted overseas.

out of 15 diamonds sold world-wide, he said.

Colin Shah, MD, Kama Jewellery, said that the proposal cuts the procurement cycle by 15-20 days and eliminates middleman markups, ultimately lowering raw material costs up to 5 per cent and boosting India’s price competitiveness in key international markets.

The move has the potential to unlock an additional \$3-5 billion of polished diamond exports and redefine the positioning of India as the world’s primary processing hub to trading capital of rough diamonds in the long run, he added.

CHALLENGE TO DUBAI?
Currently, Dubai holds 75-80 per cent of roughs trading business, and 90 per cent of the rough diamond buyers are from India.

Kirit Bhansali, Chairman, Gem and Jewellery Export Promotion Council (GJEPC), said that the Bill, once passed by both the Houses, will be a game changer for the rough trading hub, and it was a long pending demand from GJEPC to the Ministry.

If India allows rough diamond trading tax-free from SNZs, miners across the world will come here to do their business, and this will benefit MSMEs as their trips to Antwerp and Dubai can be avoided, he said.

India will emerge as a trading hub for roughs as it already cuts and polishes 14

TRADING HUB
Aarav Bafna, Director, Akoirah by Augmont, said the move could encourage mining companies and international suppliers to bring more of their inventory directly to Indian buyers.

For the Indian industry, it mean better access to rough supply, greater price discovery, more competition among suppliers and potentially more efficient procurement, he said.

Prithviraj Kothari, President, India Bullion and Jewellers Association, said domestic processors could buy raw materials locally, bypassing traditional trading capitals like Antwerp or Dubai.

Buy copper futures at ₹1,322

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl, research bureau

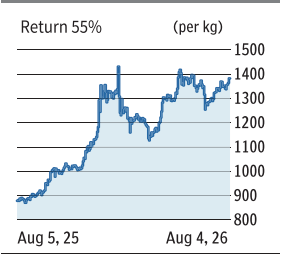
Copper futures (₹1,368/kg) have been witnessing an uptrend for over a month now. Recently, the contract rebounded from the support at ₹1,325. The prevailing price action shows that further strengthening is very likely.

August futures, which bounced off the 21-day moving average at ₹1,325 last week, have surpassed the resistance at ₹1,360, opening the door for further rally.

COMMODITY CALL.

Although there is a hurdle ahead at ₹1,375, given the momentum, we expect copper futures to surpass this and rally to ₹1,400 in the near-term.

A breakout of this could



lift it further higher to ₹1,430. On the other hand, if the contract declines from the current level and breaches the support at ₹1,325, it might lead to a deeper decline, possibly to ₹1,300. A breach of this could turn the near-term outlook bearish. Support below ₹1,300 is at ₹1,275.

TRADE STRATEGY
Last week, we suggested buying copper futures at ₹1,322. Retain this trade but move the stop-loss higher from ₹1,300 to ₹1,345. Book profits at ₹1,395.

IMD predicts heavy rain for parts of South India

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

A surge in monsoon winds, driven by powerful weather systems over the western Pacific, is set to keep parts of India under strong winds and heavy rain even as a rapidly strengthening El Nino continues to weaken rainfall across Central, Western and Southern India.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said the enhanced monsoon flow had triggered a cyclonic circulation over the south-east Bay of Bengal, while another persists over south Tamil Nadu–Puducherry.

Thunder squalls with wind speeds of 50-60 kmph, gusting up to 70 kmph, are forecast over the Andaman and Nicobar Islands over the next five days.

Myanmar’s Met office has also indicated the formation

of a low-pressure area nearby. The vigorous wind regime is expected to sustain strong surface winds and frequent showers along parts of the West Coast and the interior peninsula.

WEST PACIFIC STORMS
The strengthened monsoon flow appears to be linked to tropical storm *Kujira* over the South China Sea near the Philippines and Category-2 Typhoon Dolphin over the western Pacific.

Together, the systems are reinforcing the broader monsoon circulation extending into the Bay of Bengal.

The enhanced flow has also spawned cyclonic circulations over north-east Bihar, central Assam, north-east Bangladesh and south interior Karnataka, likely to trigger widespread clouding, thunderstorms, moderate to heavy rain, and snowfall over the higher reaches.

RAINFALL SCENARIO
Along the West Coast, the IMD has forecast isolated heavy rainfall over the Konkan and Goa on Thursday. Madhya Maharashtra is also likely to receive isolated very heavy rainfall on Thursday. Assam and Meghalaya, along with Nagaland, Tripura, Manipur and Mizoram, are likely to receive isolated heavy rainfall during the next six days.

Over South India, isolated heavy rainfall is forecast over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal and coastal Karnataka during the next three days, Kerala and Mahe for four days, and coastal Andhra Pradesh and Yanam on Saturday and Sunday.

In North India, the monsoon trough passed through Sri Ganganagar, Rohtak, Shahjahanpur, Sultanpur, Gaya, Bankura and thence eastwards towards Mizoram. Unless the eastern end of the

trough dips southward into the Bay, the conditions will remain unfavourable for the formation of a low-pressure area capable of drawing moisture inland and reviving monsoon activity over rain-deficient regions.

VERY HEAVY RAIN
The IMD has forecast isolated very heavy rainfall over west Uttar Pradesh on Thursday and east Rajasthan on Friday and Saturday.

Isolated heavy rainfall is also likely over Jammu, Kashmir and Ladakh for three days from Sunday; Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand for six days; Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi and Punjab on Thursday; west Uttar Pradesh on Friday; east Uttar Pradesh on Thursday; west Rajasthan for three days from Friday; and east Rajasthan on Thursday and again for three days from Sunday.

Arecanut area up 30% in 5 years, but output dips

AJ Vinayak
Mangaluru

India has seen an increase of around 30 per cent in the area under arecanut cultivation in the past five years. However, total production and productivity have declined significantly.

The total area under arecanut increased from 8.49 lakh hectares (lh) in 2021-22 to 11.06 lh in 2025-26 (second advance estimates), an addition of 2.56 lh. Non-traditional arecanut-growing States such as Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh in south India, and Meghalaya and Nagaland in the North-East, have seen significant growth in area and production over the last five years.

Karnataka, which accounts for 71.56 per cent of the country’s total area (7.98

lakh hectares) and 75.47 per cent of total production (11.32 lakh tonnes), has seen a 32.42 per cent increase in area, and a decline of 16 per cent and 36.6 per cent, respectively, in production and productivity over the last five years.

According to data furnished by the government in the Lok Sabha, arecanut production declined to 15.29 lakh tonnes (lt) in 2025-26 (second advance estimates) from 16.66 lt in 2021-22, and productivity declined to 1.38 tonne per hectare from 1.96 tonne per hectare.

The percentage growth in the area under cultivation was steep in Meghalaya (195.15 per cent) over the last five years, followed by Nagaland (177.14 per cent), Andhra Pradesh (171.17 per cent), and Tamil Nadu (92.25 per cent).

‘TN finances in a difficult position but showing signs of improvement’

PRUDENT POLICY. It is not wrong to borrow, but we have to borrow for development, says Finance Secretary

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Tamil Nadu’s finances remain in a “difficult position” but have begun showing signs of improvement after the last few months of corrective measures, Finance Secretary MA Siddique said on Wednesday.

“We have tried to make a balanced effort,” he told mediapersons, noting that the Budget focuses on improving revenue collections, optimising expenditure and bringing efficiency into operations, while retaining the goal of citizen’s welfare.

The Secretary said nearly ₹2,000 crore of the ₹15,000 crore of revenue mobilisation target that Finance Minister N Marie Wilson mentioned in his Budget speech had come in.



We are seeing a minimum savings of 10% in procurement today compared to what was shown earlier. In some cases, even 20%

MA SIDDIQUE
Finance Secretary, Tamil Nadu



“There are other efforts which have been made, particularly on the liquor side, where we have achieved about ₹1,500 crore (in fiscal space). Action is also being taken on the stamps and duties registration side to review the anomalies in areas like guideline value.”

Per Siddique, the government intends to use these savings to gradually roll out new schemes promised in the

vision document. However, he stated that this would take time and would commence in phases over the next year or two.

Responding to concerns over rising debt, Siddique said, “We cannot reduce the debt. It will only increase every year. What is important is that the rate at which income rises should be faster than the rate at which debt rises.” The ratio of Liability

to GSDP is expected to ease further to 26.57 per cent in 2027-28 and 26.10 per cent in 2028-29.

Tamil Nadu’s fiscal deficit is budgeted around ₹1.22 lakh crore or around 3 per cent of the Gross State Domestic Product. While the government intends to adhere to this level, he said they may seek additional borrowing headroom from the Centre for sectors such as power, where investments are needed at the moment, and could help generate long-term economic returns.

CAPEX CLARIFICATION

Addressing concerns over the reduction in capital expenditure compared with the previous DMK government’s Interim Budget estimates, Siddique noted that the capex estimates of ₹56,985 crore in this Budget repres-

ent an increase of around 11 per cent over 2025-26, while reductions from the Interim Budget largely reflect the removal of overstated estimates. Capex is projected to be ₹68,382 crore in 2027-28 and ₹83,426 crore in 2028-29, according to the Budget documents.

Finance Minister Marie Wilson, in his Budget speech, said that the State will also constitute a high-level Expenditure Reforms Committee to advise on rationalising expenditure, enhance service delivery modes and review the positive impact of welfare schemes, among others.

Siddique underlined the importance of expenditure discipline. “We are seeing a minimum saving of 10 per cent in procurement today compared to what was shown earlier. In some cases, even 20 per cent,” he said.

TVK’s first Budget versus DMK’s interim budget: More or less the same

Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

Expectations were high that the TVK government, in its maiden Budget, would break the mould and bring in radical changes to manage the State’s finances. But has it done so?

DATA FOCUS.

We compared the interim budget for FY27 presented by the DMK government with the full Budget of the TVK. The numbers are not vastly different. Revenue expenses are high while capex gets hit. The debt overhang continues.

FISCAL STRAIN

The Budget projects revenue expenditure of ₹4.05 lakh crore. This is 3.2 per cent higher than the ₹3.93 lakh crore projected in the interim budget of the DMK, indicating that the new government is unlikely to rein in wasteful expenditure. Revenue receipts are up 1.6 per cent to ₹3.50 lakh crore, resulting in the revenue deficit widening from ₹48,696 crore to ₹55,775 crore.

At the same time, capital expenditure is budgeted 4.3 per cent lower at ₹56,985 crore, while net loans and advances are projected to be 33.8 per cent lower at ₹9,075 crore. Despite these changes, the fiscal deficit has been retained at 3 per cent of GSDP, while the outstanding debt ratio is largely unchanged at 27.01 per cent.

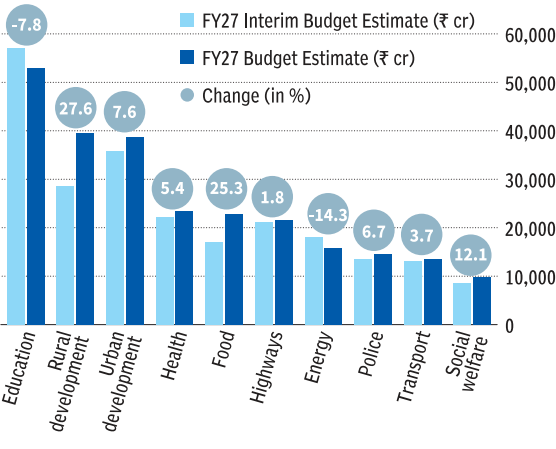
The deterioration in the revenue balance is primarily driven by higher day-to-day expenditure rather than investment. Newly announced welfare schemes, including ‘Annan Seer’ for brides and ‘Thai Maaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam’, have substantially increased the subsidies and grants com-

Key takeaways

Fiscal health

	FY27 Interim Budget Estimate (DMK) (₹ cr)	FY27 Budget Estimate (TVK) (₹ cr)	Change (in %)
Revenue receipts	3,44,575	3,50,027	1.6
Revenue expenditure	3,93,272	4,05,802	3.2
Revenue deficit	48,696	55,775	14.5
Capital expenditure	59,562	56,985	-4.3
Net loans & advances	13,708	9,075	-33.8
Fiscal deficit (as % of GSDP)	3	3	
Outstanding debt (as % of GSDP)	27.03	27.01	

Major sectoral allocations



Source: TN Budget documents

ponent of revenue expenditure.

REVENUE PUSH

A *businessline* analysis indicates that the subsidies and grants component of revenue expenditure is nearly ₹18,000 crore, or about 12 per cent, higher than the interim Budget estimates for FY27. The increase is notable because the second-largest revenue expenditure head, that is salaries, is projected to decline by around ₹3,000 crore, or 3.55 per cent, suggesting that the higher spending is largely welfare-driven rather than arising from employee costs.

The government expects a fall in its own tax revenue by almost ₹3,000 crore, driven

mostly by the slowdown in commercial tax collections. However, it expects increased inflow of about ₹8,000 crore under grants-in-aid from the Union government, compared to its predecessors.

The sectoral allocation pattern also marks a shift from the interim budget. Rural development records the largest increase among major departments; food spending grows 25.3 per cent, while social welfare receives 12.1 per cent more.

Urban development increases 7.6 per cent to ₹38,715 crore, health rises 5.4 per cent to ₹23,357 crore, and police, transport and highways also receive modest increases.

State govt announces ₹1 lakh subsidy for rooftop solar under PM SuryaGhar

Our Bureau
Chennai

The State government announced a subsidy of up to ₹1 lakh for domestic consumers installing solar panels under the ‘Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana’ rooftop solar scheme and allocated ₹50 crore to implement this subsidy.

The move aims to bolster rooftop solar at a time when its adoption in the State has lagged in comparison to other States like Maharashtra, Gujarat and Uttar Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh.

As of July 2026, Tamil Nadu’s rooftop solar capacity stood at 316 MW, with 87,039 installations across 1.03 lakh households.

Industry executives had earlier called for stronger policy support from the State government for rooftop solar.

P Sivakumar, President of

Tamil Nadu Solar Energy Developers Association (TNSEDA) and CEO of Shriram Solar, said, “Any financial support from the State government will be beneficial as it will lower the upfront costs, which is especially good for residential customers. The next step must be to streamline the application and approval process at the discom level.”

BESS POLICY

The government has initiated plans to formulate a new ‘BESS Promotion Policy,’ which will facilitate private investment in this sector.

Smart meters will be installed for all consumers in Chennai city, as well as for 50 lakh industrial and commercial consumers across other parts of the State.

TRANSMISSION INFRA

The government also plans to expedite Phase-II of the Green Energy Corridor Pro-

ject, valued at ₹1,187 crore and crucial to evacuating renewable energy from southern Tamil Nadu.

As for the broader power sector, the announcements included plans to expedite multiple thermal power projects including the Udangudi Stage-I and Ennore SEZ Thermal Power Projects, which will together add 2,640 MW to the State’s power generation capacity.

Over 178 sub-stations will be added at an investment of ₹1,543 crore to strengthen the power distribution infrastructure and 40,000 old transformers will be replaced in a phased manner at a cost of ₹2,000 crore.

Transmission networks will be upgraded and a ₹4,000 crore transmission line project between Coimbatore and Ariyalur and a ₹1,640 crore transmission project between Virudhunagar and Coimbatore will be set up.

TN Budget: New industrial policy, AI approvals to spur growth

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government has unveiled an ambitious industrial roadmap to become a \$1.5-trillion economy by 2036, with a focus on balanced regional development, advanced manufacturing and employment generation.

Presenting the 2026-27 Budget in the Assembly on Wednesday, Finance Minister N Marie Wilson announced that Sipcot will establish industrial parks in backward districts based on district-specific industrial plans and sectoral strengths. The parks will be developed at an estimated cost of ₹3,200 crore over the next five years, with infrastructure suited to investor needs.

The State has allocated ₹6,556 crore for the Industries and MSME departments in the Revised Budget Estimates. This is around 12 per cent higher than the 2025-26 full Budget and marginally higher than the previous government’s interim budget allocation in February 2026.

INDUSTRY POLICY

The Minister said the government had signed seven investment MoUs worth ₹35,062 crore, with the potential to generate 14,790 direct and indirect jobs.

The government plans to establish more multi-modal logistics parks (MMLPs) and dry ports at strategic locations, promote petrochemical and ancillary industries, and explore the possibility of setting up ports in Tamil Nadu.

A new Tamil Nadu Industrial Policy will be unveiled to foster innovation, techno-



Tamil Nadu Finance Minister N Marie Wilson presenting the Budget

logy-driven growth, emerging industries, sustainable manufacturing and exports. The government will also create the Tamil Nadu Industrial Capability Directory, a digital platform showcasing the State’s manufacturing and supply-chain capabilities to prospective investors.

Under the MSME department, the Budget also announced a new ₹300-crore Green Steel Production Initiative over the next five years to encourage environmentally sustainable steel manufacturing.

For ease of doing business, the government will introduce “Guidance 3.0”, an AI-powered investment facilitation system that offers information, approvals and investor services through a single platform. The upgraded Tamil Nadu Single Window Portal 3.0 will enable industries to obtain statutory approvals, clearances and no-objection certificates through a unified online interface.

In a major push for southern Tamil Nadu, Thoothukudi and Tirunelveli will be declared Space Industrial Investment Zone, leveraging the upcoming spaceport at Kulasekarapattinam. The State government, in collaboration

with IN-SPACe, will establish a Space Vehicle Common Technical Facility to support private companies, start-ups and research organisations in the sector.

Industries Minister S Keerthana said the Industries Department had received “a historic allocation” of ₹4,414 crore. “This reflects our government’s unwavering commitment to manufacturing, investment, innovation and quality job creation.”

RIGHT DIRECTION

Purushothaman, Chairman, CII Southern Region, said, “This Budget delivers on the fundamentals of industrial competitiveness, AI-led investment facilitation and infrastructure built for scale.”

Battery storage, rooftop solar, smart metering, and EV charging networks are core to Tamil Nadu’s pitch as India’s top investment destination. These steps will also help MSMEs unlock the full potential of India’s free trade agreements and propel manufacturing growth across the State.

A Viswanathan, President, The Madras Chamber of Commerce & Industry, said, “The maiden Budget of the new government sets a positive direction by giving priority to manufacturing, infrastructure, technology, MSMEs, skill development and ease of doing business. These are all critical to Tamil Nadu’s long-term growth and global competitiveness.”

The Chamber praised the proposed Industrial Policy, the SPEED platform for faster approvals, the expansion of SIPCOT parks, the Space Industrial Investment Zone, the AI Mission, and the proposed AI and Innovation City.

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)-led State government has identified artificial intelligence (AI) as a key priority, with its first Budget including multiple AI-focused initiatives to improve education, governance and industrial growth.

The government announced the establishment of an AI and innovation city called ‘Arivagam’, where AI companies, start-ups, global capability centres (GCCs), and research institutions working in domains such as quantum technology and computer infrastructure will come together to develop the State’s AI and deep tech ecosystem.

The AI city will include an AI university, an international skill development centre, a semiconductor hardware testing lab, innovation incubators and residential infrastructure.

A feasibility study for the establishment of the AI city will be undertaken at an estimated cost of ₹5 crore.

AI EXPANSION

The government also plans to expand the scope of the TN AI Mission to encompass emerging technologies such as quantum technology, robotics and animation, visual effects, gaming, comics, and extended reality (AVGC-XR).

Recognising the need to bring in AI earlier, the government also launched the AI Industry Development Programme with experts from academia and industry curating specialised AI curricula for higher education.

It also announced plans to expand the Tamil Nadu

promote environmentally sustainable textile production. For this purpose, the TTTC will be established with a financial outlay of ₹10 crore, he said.

INDUSTRY BOOST

The Tiruppur Exporters Association said the government’s initiatives will strengthen the competitiveness of Tiruppur’s knitwear and textile industry.

At the same time, it expressed confidence that the State government would favourably consider the long-pending demands of the knitwear industry, including the formation of a Knitwear Board, the conversion of the ₹200 crore loan extended for common effluent treatment plants for dyeing units into a subsidy, and the establishment of a regional office/procurement centre of the Cotton Corporation of India.

TN unveils plans for design institute, technical textiles scheme and Tiruppur technology centre

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government has announced a series of initiatives to strengthen the textile and apparel ecosystem, including the establishment of a Tamil Nadu Institute of Design, the creation of a Tiruppur Textiles Technology Centre (TTTC) with an investment of ₹10 crore, and a scheme to promote technical textiles.

The announcements were made in the State Budget for 2026-27, which also allocated ₹1,678 crore to the Handlooms, Handicrafts, Textiles, and Khadi Department in the revised estimates.

DESIGN INSTITUTE

The proposed TNID will be established as an institution of State importance, with active participation from in-



dustry and academia. A detailed project report will be prepared for the institute, Finance Minister N Marie Wilson announced.

“Despite Tamil Nadu being one of India’s largest hubs for textiles, apparel, handlooms, handicrafts, and manufacturing, it lacks a dedicated institution that integrates design education, innovation, research, product development, and entrepreneurship for these sectors,” he said.

The government stated that Tamil Nadu’s contribu-

tion to technical textiles remains relatively low, despite being one of the country’s leading textile-producing States. This is mainly due to limited awareness and inadequate access to advanced technologies and international expertise.

To tap into the growing opportunities in technical textiles, the government will launch the Technical Textiles Transformation Scheme for Entrepreneurs under the Tamil Nadu Technical Textiles Mission. This initiative will be implemented in collaboration with international educational and research institutions to help entrepreneurs, micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs), and textile manufacturers diversify into technical textiles, he said.

The infrastructure facilities in Tiruppur will be upgraded in multiple phases to

MoD agrees to fully reimburse 18% GST on R&D grants

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

More than a year after *businessline* wrote about the government taxing innovation, the Ministry of Defence (MoD) has finally settled the anomaly in grants to industry and institutions for research and development (R&D) of military products.

The MoD issued an office memorandum on July 27, clarifying that the full 18 per cent GST will be reimbursed to entities receiving grants for defence product R&D and innovation, regardless of the input tax credit (ITC) amount claimed.

The Ministry provides grants to industry through iDEX schemes and under the Technology Development Fund (TDF), managed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation.

The GST is calculated on the full value of goods or

services provided, but the final tax amount actually paid to the government is determined after the ITC is deducted.

TAX ANOMALY

In the exclusive report published on March 10, 2025, *businessline* questioned the government’s double standards, slapping an 18 per cent GST on R&D grants to private firms but exempting government entities from levying a similar tax.

Two days later, the MoD swung into action and reached out to MSMEs that had received notices from the GST Commissionerates across the country to address the disparity in tax treatment between public and private players engaged in defence research. Later, in July, the Ministry decided to reimburse the 18 per cent GST.

“Approval is hereby conveyed for the reimbursement of GST, as applicable,

over and above the grant-in-aid provided to MSMEs and start-ups under the TDF and iDEX schemes, based on documentary evidence and taking into account the avail of input-tax credit, prospectively,” the MoD said in an office memorandum issued on July 18, 2025.

FRESH CLARIFICATION

Addressing whether the GST reimbursement should cover the entire grant or be reduced by the ITC claimed by the entities providing the R&D services,” the accessed official letter revealed.

The Ministry said the decision had been taken in consultation with the Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance.

The MoD also stated that “reimbursement arrangements between the parties are to be governed by contractual terms between the two parties.”

The procurement contracts awarded to iDEX winners for mass production and deployment with the tri-services have surpassed ₹1,000 crore.

Likewise, more than 79 sanctioned projects, valued at ₹334.02 crore, have come through TDF.

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Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	SZ WH	SZ WL	PE	BSE CI	Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	SZ WH	SZ WL	PE	BSE CI	Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	SZ WH	SZ WL	PE	BSE CI
Paushak	735.20	712.55	735.00	743.00	701.75	112.26	780.60	342.50			Shankara Bld	144.74	142.70	145.60	143.00	142.00	52.616	312.00	98.50		142.80	UCO Bank	26.33	26.49	26.50	26.77	26.41	3883.69	34.20	22.30	12	26.43
PavITM	100.00	142.00	142.00	143.00	141.00	30.97	143.00	30.93	60.00		Shankara Bld	1337.80	1347.80	1357.80	1365.10	1329.00	190.16	1380.00	636.00			Uflux Ltd	47.55	47.95	47.97	47.95	47.00	45.47	60.70	333.00	21	47.50
PCCF	319.50	1620.00	1610.00	1635.00	1603.00	1595.45	194.00	1364.00			Shankara Bld	218.05	216.26	220.00	220.90	216.11	259.93	274.00	155.00			UFO	68.11	69.40	68.50	69.79	67.35	41.35	92.86	53.69	16	68.89
PCBL	325.55	329.45	326.00	332.00	321.00	1563.49	425.95	256.50		9.83	Shankara Bld	840.65	822.90	848.00	848.00	820.00	232.32	1297.80	756.00	10	823.40	Upar Sugar [1]	44.98	43.28	45.04	45.20	43.05	194.34	48.88	33.16	36	43.24
PDS	352.55	357.80	354.00	359.00	351.00	67.40	418.50	246.05			Shankara Bld	687.95	901.35	897.00	907.50	890.20	44.41	1189.00	701.85	16	903.60	Upar Glob.	97.09	97.57	97.80	98.00	93.62	566.12	19.20	50.12		
PENPETRO IND	549.00	552.00	553.00	554.00	549.00	367.41	659.00	424.65	50	165.80	Shankara Bld	70.35	69.59	70.29	71.00	68.71	12303.96	73.29	41.32			Ujivan SFB	120.00	121.00	120.00	122.00	119.00	21.25	310.00	33.00	12	121.99
Petronel LNG	285.00	280.00	285.00	285.00	280.00	71.89	362.00	235.41	11	281.00	Shankara Bld	4663.70	460.40	466.50	470.00	446.00	37.19	599.00	285.50			Ultramarine	38.00	39.25	39.27	39.70	38.03	22.03	44.03	36.10		
Petrochem	285.00	285.00	285.00	285.00	285.00	285.00	285.00	285.00			Shankara Bld	30.00	30.00	30.00	30.00	30.00	25.97	238.02	186.25	11	300.65	Union Bank [2]	50.00	49.70	50.80	51.00	49.00	55.64	68.95	28.00		496.25
PE Electro [1]	61.00	60.00	61.55	63.25	60.50	3473.70	795.50	438.65	140	605.00	Shankara Bld	41.66	41.64	42.50	42.50	41.00	219.28	55.00	34.30			Unicom-eSol	86.12	85.18	86.95	86.95	84.50	159.27	155.80	78.51		
PGL [5]	212.20	210.50	213.00	214.50	208.00	100.13	216.05	118.00	150	210.00	Shankara Bld	178.08	177.07	178.08	177.07	175.29	66.00	100.00	113.50			United Aero	133.00	134.70	134.60	136.00	130.00	421.99	137.70	69.00		
Phoenix Mill [2]	132.30	130.50	134.00	136.50	129.00	17.00	394.20	216.85	140.00	129.50	Shankara Bld	40.00	39.00	40.00	40.00	38.00	25.97	238.02	186.25	11	300.65	Unitesd Credit	152.50	152.00	152.00	154.00	152.00	44.86	154.80	1210.80		
Physicorp	120.15	121.00	121.00	121.00	121.00	121.00	121.00	121.00			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			Unit Cable	142.70	142.70	142.70	144.00	144.00	111.77	147.35	57.10	11	143.90
PI INDUS. [1]	2785.50	280.00	2792.30	2825.60	2781.60	235.59	414.00	2527.30	28	2815.00	Shankara Bld	84.67	85.15	84.75	85.15	84.75	23.50	99.40	60.57			Updater-Svc	203.83	209.43	205.51	212.39	203.84	50.78	29.40	125.10		
PiccadillyAgr	78.00	76.00	79.00	77.00	77.00	21.30	80.50	55.00			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Pollmix Ind [1]	120.15	121.00	121.00	121.00	121.00	121.00	121.00	121.00			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Pine Labs [1]	151.19	147.82	151.70	151.70	147.16	10656.86	284.00	134.73			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Prime Films	205.20	213.60	204.00	215.80	204.00	336.43	222.00	126.00			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Primal Print	20.00	20.78	20.78	20.78	20.00	306.00	935.15	20.44	132.20		Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Pril Engg [5]	62.75	65.00	65.40	65.40	64.40	10.84	10.84	10.84			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Pri Transm	168.30	172.20	171.00	172.90	168.00	11.84	139.70	122.01			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Platinumind	22.73	22.74	23.01	23.03	22.60	37.60	34.20	183.50			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Plr Capital Inv	55.15	65.875	65.00	66.55	65.45	35.75	73.60	103.00			Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
Pnb Gifs	82.79	83.75	82.81	85.81	84.58	10.94	35.75	58.75	15	83.85	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNB Housing	108.00	112.10	107.60	115.40	107.20	50.70	114.55	70.80	12	112.60	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
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PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	53	577.00
PNC Infra [2]	25.00	25.45	25.05	26.00	25.00	29.94	325.15	15.75	19	25.45	Shankara Bld	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10	1087.10			UPL [2]	581.90	577.25	581.90	583.90	576.00	346.66	81.20	56.25	5	